CENSUS OF INDIA 1961
VOLUME XX—PART VI—No. 10

HIMACHAL PRADESH

A Village Survey of

CHITRARI

[Chamba Tehsil, Chamba District]

Field Investigation by
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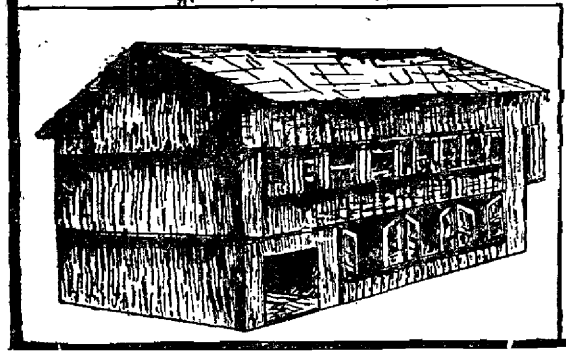
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HIMACHAL PRADESH

CHITRARI

NOTIONAL MAP



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simply to performing the religious rites. However, a change occurred with time when they had to accept the subsidiary occupations of agriculture, business and rearing of goats and sheep. Common *gotras* of the Brahmins in Chitrari are Bhardwaj, Attri, Gautam, Gour, Jangnailu and Tutran.

They do not eat with the scheduled castes. But their services to them at the time of marriages and performance of other religious rites are always available without any inhibitions. In lieu of these they accept either cash or kind payment as *dakshina*. With the *swarn* castes, on the other hand, they eat.

Khatris—In the wake of persecution initiated by the Mughal Emperor Aurangzeb, Hindus belonging to different castes migrated in large numbers to these high hills. Leaving aside the Brahmins and low castes, others developed kinship with the Rajputs who were already settled here. In the meantime, the two castes of Rajputs and Khatris became so much intermingled that one could not be distinguished from the other. Some of the families call themselves Rajputs and the others as Khatri. As for the profession, they practise agriculture, business, sheep and goat rearing.

Rathis—The Rathis of the village have no version to relate with regard to their origin, so we depend upon the Chamba Gazetteer. According to the study made by the Gazetteer in 1904, 'No traditions exist among them, as among the Gaddis, pointing to migration from the plains—. In origin they are generally regarded as being the result of an amalgamation of the castes above and below them—.' A more probable explanation of their origin is referred to by Sir J. B. Lyall. He says, "There is an idea current in the hills that of the land-holding castes the Thakurs, Rathis, Kunets and Girths are either indigenous to the hills or indigenous by the half-blood, and that the Brahmins, Rajputs and others are the descendants of invaders and settlers from the plains."

By way of *gotra*, Rathis are divided into two sections Kashyap and Attri.

Next to the *swarns* are Badhis, Aryas—Halis and Bensis who form the lower rung of the dependant classes.

Badhis—The name of the caste is occupational and indicates that the families concerned are engaged in carpentry. Their *gotra* is Dhundya.

Aryas—Halis—The word is derived from the word *Hal*. Their principal occupation is farm work and they also work as servants to the landholders.

Bensis—This is the smaller caste and is probably an off-shoot of Aryas or Halis. Apart from doing all jobs, they remove the carcases of dead animals. By way of *gotras*, the Aryas and Bensis are Ghamnan, Lalwan, Bharadwaj, Bhamitay and Podotan.

Inter-Caste Relationship

In the countryside, the caste system continues to hold its sway. In the secluded parts it essentially regulates the social behaviour. The dominance of one caste group led to the economic subordination of the other and sometimes the phenomenon has been interpreted as an integrated community life. In the same way, Brahmins and Rathis being the dominant caste groups of the village developed superiority complex and the other castes practically depended upon them. This economic inter-dependance was given the name of *khaloti* or *jajmani*.

The Badhis or Lohars are given the work of carpenters and blacksmiths and both prepare and carry out repairs to agricultural implements. Their assistance in the construction of houses is indispensable.

In exchange of the services they are paid in kind at harvesting. 8 seers of barley and wheat are given at the time of *rabi*. The same quantity is given on the occasion of *kharif* harvest.

Regarding caste relationship between the swarns on the one hand and the Aryas and Bensis on the other, one observes a difference emerging between the accumulated tradition and common practice. Possibly it has been prompted by the legal prescription and a changed political set-up and above all the altered economic relationships. The Halis with whom it was a social obligation to remove the carcases of dead animals no longer do so and work either as labourers or on the farms. Now the job is done by the Chamars or *Khalara* as he is called who repairs shoes. By way of remuneration he gets 8 seers of maize from every household.

Residential Pattern

The village is not laid out in any systematic way and a number of factors seem to have determined the pattern of settlement. The temple is the main attraction and this is surrounded on all sides by houses. Evidently it is clear from the situation of old houses that the first settlers occupied the space around the temple or near about. Closeness to the water sources is the other criterion. A cluster of houses all about the water springs has sprung up in the course of time. The main foot-path passes by the

temple and cuts across the village. The shops are located on either side of the path.

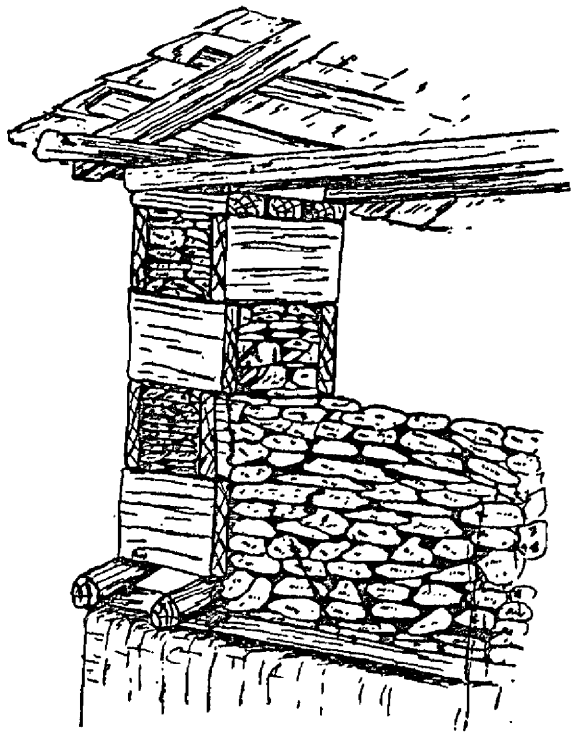
Due to the mountainous nature of the place, approach from one end to the other is provided by narrow paths. The village is divided into nine sections namely Basarka, Chitrari I, Kalanka, Brainka, Chitrari II, Chachian, Kamharki, Ukhli and Charauta. The cluster of houses in these sections is essentially a mushroom growth. The higher castes live intermingled but the tradition has kept aloof the lower castes. Aryas and Bensis live in Basarka.

House Type

In all there are 106 housing structures scattered indiscriminately all over the village and invariably the lay-out of the house is rectangular. Except in the case of the Government and Panchayat buildings which have been constructed recently and are spotted out by their gleaming G.I. roofs others use the local and traditional raw material. The use of cement and glass-panes is only found in a few newly built buildings, mostly in the public sector. The houses may be of two or three storeys, the three storeyed houses being more prominent. If the houses are situated in the open they may have a spacious courtyard attached to them, with the walls two feet high at the most running all around. This court-yard is paved with flat thick stones or slates. The foundations are fixed in the ground, two to three and a half feet deep, to support a heavy stone structure of dry masonry.

It has been found in the old houses that the plinth level comes up to the ground only. The rooms no doubt are spaciously built but are dark and dingy at the same time. They have very small doors and practically no ventilation.

The Gaddis have their own way of constructing the walls. Rough wooden planks of the sizes two to two and a half feet in length, one and a half feet in breadth and one to two inches in thickness are used in an adequate number to erect the hollow pillars at the two extremities and one at the centre. Two *chewel* or joists, exactly parallel to each other, one to the inner-most and the other to the outer-most surface of the wall are fixed at the intervals of three to four feet. The thickness of the walls is kept at about two feet and are made of roughly hewn stones of different sizes and the hollow structures so erected are filled in with dry masonry consisting of small type of stones. The use of mortar or lime is completely absent. Villagers go on placing chiselled



stones skilfully avoiding any hole until it is completed. After the wall has been completed and the pillars erected, these are plastered with a thick layer of mud mixed with some cowdung and local straw. Hitherto white washing has been hardly known to them. Of late, however, the well-to-do households have taken to the use of both cement and white-washing.

Farque type of walls—Walls are constructed of Farque type. The peculiarity of this wall lies in the fact that instead of filling the space in between the joists with dry masonry, wooden planks are fixed here. Generally it is the walls of the second storey which are built on this pattern. One very distinctive custom relates to keeping the two sides open of the upper-most storey in a few cases. It looks similar to the verandah and is called *sal* in the local dialect. This open space is usually utilized for the bundles of grass and firewood to be stacked about. Generally wooden verandahs are attached to the houses.

Roofing—Rough and coarse slates of irregular shape are used for the purpose of roofing which is a single slate structure. The roof has four slopes which are quite steep. The pieces of slates are fixed on 1" thick planks

which rest on purlins of 2" × 3" specifications. The purlins are fixed on wooden rafters of a little more thickness, say 4" × 4". One end each of the rafters rests on the wooden plates fixed in the top of the wall. The other rests on the central beam of the room which may be one foot in thickness. In many houses the slates are fixed directly on the purlins thus avoiding the use of extra planks.

Source of Material—The materials used in the construction of the houses are obtained locally and are to be found within a radius of four to five miles. Timber, stone, slates and clay or *chik* are used for construction purposes. The biggest limiting factor against the use of paints, varnish and window panes is the economy of the people. In place of lime a form of light grey coloured clay is used which is extracted half a mile away. Although it acquires a shine after application but when it is dried up it lacks the sticking properties. Iron handles, bolts and screws are manufactured by the local blacksmiths for which pig iron is procured from Chamba.

The bonafide right holders of Chitrari enjoy certain concessional rates of timber for constructing their own houses from the local unclassified protected forests and demarcated protected forests. The rates charged per tree are:—

Name of tree	Diameter in inches	Rates
Deodar	28 to 32	7·00
Deodar	24 to 28	5·00
Deodar	20 to 24	3·00
Deodar	16 to 19	2·00
Deodar	12 to 15	1·00
Deodar	8 to 12	0·50
Deodar	under 8	0·25
Kail	24 and over	2·00
Kail	20 to 24	1·50
Kail	16 to 19	1·00
Kail	12 to 15	0·50
Kail	8 to 12	0·25
Kail	under 8	0·12
Fir tree	24 and over	0·50
Fir tree	20 to 23	0·25
Fir tree	16 to 19	0·12
Fir tree	12 to 15	0·06
Fir tree	Under 12	free
Other B. Leaved	..	0·12 each

LP(D)15SCO H.P.

The same rooms are shared by more than one household by putting up a make-shift screen of wooden planks and trunks or almirahs. To have an exact idea about the shortage of space, the case of Mehar Chand and Dhani Ram is cited. They are living in the same room. Occasionally *obra*, the ground floor may be partitioned and utilized for sleeping. Similarly extension is made to the ground floor in the form of *obra* when there are more cattle. In that case a small-sized cabinet is erected by a rough and uneven lot of wooden planks along with the outer wall of the *obra*. Here nails are not used generally.

Generally a house is three storeyed. Wood and stone form the main material used for the ceiling, wall and floor. The roofs have slates often. Small doors, ill ventilated rooms and family large rooms may be common. The oldest house is an *apthakuri* house built during the reigns of the Thakurs and it looks so distinctively old. Mehtoo, a Brahmin has a three storeyed house. The walls of the rooms are 2 feet in thickness and are built on the traditional pattern.

Obra—This is the ground floor and is used exclusively as cattle shed. The room is 17.9′×16′×7′ and has a mud floorings. All about the room, wooden pegs are fixed in the ground to tie the cattle. A passage 24 feet in length with a breadth of 7 feet is attached to it. There is only one entrance to the room and the length and width of this are 5 × 2 × 5 feet respectively.

The room has windows of the specifications 2.5 × 3 and 2 × 3 and one smoke outlet which is 9" × 9". Provision has also been made for two inches with specifications 9" × 9" and 9" × 1". Agricultural implements are stored in one of its corners. Nearby, one small pit is dug to conserve the cow-dung and urine.

Oberi—This is the first floor of the storey and one has to go on a small thin wooden stair-case peculiar to the hills and is full of niches. The room is built on the same specifications as the ground floor with a passage of 16 feet long and 7 feet wide. The floor is made of one inch thick wooden planks with thick mud plastering. This is the living room. In other cases it may also serve the purpose of cooking and even for having a bath. One wooden almirah is there in one corner. Provision has been made for five windows.

Bhor—The upper most storey or the second floor is known as *bhor*. The size of the room and the passage is exactly similarly to

the one in the first floor with the difference that here the passage is provided for by erecting a wooden partition. The room is used for sleeping and cooking. In winter because of the warmth resulting from the cooking the households are saved to some extent from the bitter cold prevailing in the region. A loom is fixed in the balcony. In one corner is the hearth and nearby a platform used for keeping the utensils and other household goods. On one side are placed the wooden grain boxes.

The balcony is used by the owners, especially the women folk for basking in the sun. Scratching each others head for lices is a common sight. The height of the walls is kept deliberately low because of the snow-bound character of the region. The same very reason explains the lowness of the doors and one has to bow a little to enter the house. The entire expenses of construction are borne by the individuals concerned and in the present case the cost has been worked out at Rs. 6,000. There is no custom of obtaining the help from the fellow villagers on reciprocal basis.

The main difficulty lies in obtaining the timber which is brought from the nearby jungles of Nanon and Nhru after getting the permission of the Forest Department. Transportation is another problem. The material has to be brought by the porters. The construction of the houses is executed by the masons and carpenters from nearby villages. One carpenter lives in the village which does the wood work and charges at the rate of Rs. 4/- or 5/- a day. The masons charge Rs. 2/- daily. The aesthetic sense reflects in the quaint figures drawn on the walls in varied colours of pink, yellow and red. The motifs are primarily concerned with their religious beliefs and practices.

The total number of households classified by the number of rooms and also by the number of persons occupying them would be clear from the table—

Number of households classified by number of rooms and number of persons occupying

Total Number of Households	Total No. of Rooms	Total No. of Persons	Households with one room		Households with two rooms		Households with three rooms		Households with four rooms		Households with five rooms		Households with five rooms and more	
			No. of Households	Total No. of family members	No. of households	Total No. of family members	No. of Households	Total No. of family members	No. of Households	Total No. of family members	No. of Households	Total No. of family members	No. of Households	Total No. of family members
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15
80	249	404	10	40	13	57	44	222	3	20	3	16	7	45

Every one has shelter even if it be one room. On an average, one room accommodates two persons. But the position gets all the more crystallized when we take into account the fact that a large number of rooms are used exclusively as cattle sheds.

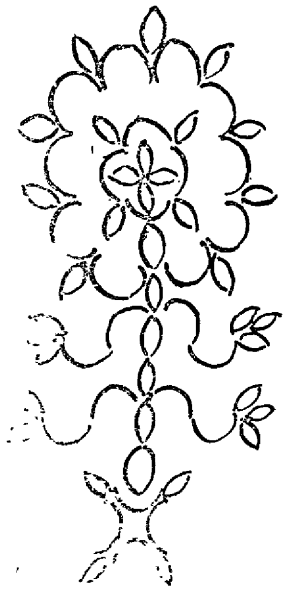
Rituals—The local priest is consulted for laying the foundation of a new house. The site is approved by him. In case it is considered unlucky, he suggests some sort of propitiatory worship and *dan*. A goat or sheep is sacrificed. Then the foundation stone is laid in compliance with the injunction made by the priest. The cross-beam is laid at the auspicious time and a piece of goat or sheep sacrified is tied to it to ward off evil spirits. Before the first entry is made to the house, *nawala* is offered to Lord Shiva to invoke his blessings.

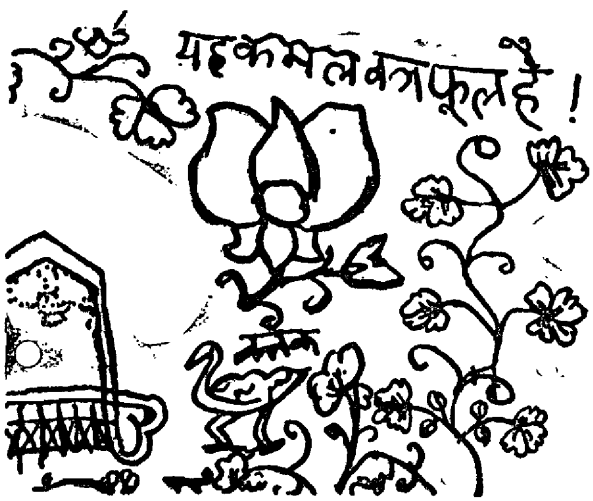
The blessings of goddess 'Shiv Shakti Devi' are invoked in the temple. Facing of the house is kept towards the east and as an alternative south is chosen. There is no specific reason for facing towards these sides.

Apart from carrying out day to day repairs to their houses, only four new houses have been constructed during the last five years. One of them is purely a wooden structure built entirely in the slightly modern style and costs Rs. 12,000. The other two are small houses, each costing Rs. 500. The fourth one has cost Rs. 4,000.

Local names are given here:—

1. *Thattara*—Hollow pillars.
2. *Manjhi or Pasan*—Staircase.
3. *Dhaurri*—Entrance or door.





4. *Gharyali*—A platform near the kitchen used for keeping the utensils.
5. *Chara*—An outlet for the outflow of water in one corner of the room.
6. *Dragala or Behi*—Projected verandah in the floor.
7. *Khudi*—Niche in the wall.
8. *Tohlu*—Round holes in the partitioned wall.
9. *Thumbi*—Wooden pillars.
10. *Chobu*—An opening to the second floor from *obra* in one corner.
11. *Bonti*—A slate is removed to serve as an outlet for smoke.
12. *Hadupu*—Platform erected by the side of kitchen hearth for keeping the utensils.
13. *Thhatasaris*—The thick planks on which slates are fixed.
14. *Nahas*—The thick plank or *thhatasaris* which rest on the wooden purlins.
15. *Kanaran*—One end each of the rafters rests on the wooden plates fixed in the wall, the other end on the central beam.
16. *Farque*—When wooden planks are fixed in between joists instead of filling the space with masonry such walls are called *farques* and are generally in the second storey.

Migration

Some villagers own goats and sheep. Each shepherd is allotted a particular pasture of *dhar* for his own flock consisting of a number of goats and sheep. Intensive grazing for generations led to erosion. To check this trouble passes are issued. The areas round about have been declared Reserved Forests and the infringement of the rules is followed either by cash penalty or forfeiture of the animal.

The persons who take to this seasonal migration are the ones who have a sizeable flock to tend. They readily get work during the intervening period. A few of them migrate during the winter. They do so out of convention and due to the cold and to get a grazing ground for the flocks.

A few have purchased some land. The number of migratories thus hardly comes to 15 per cent of the total population.

Migration starts in September-October and is collectively known as *gana*. The route adopted is generally the shortest one and a number of mountain ranges have to be crossed over to reach the plains of Shahpur and Kangra. There are a number of passes in the outer Himalaya or *Dhaula Dhar* between the Ravi valley and Bhattiyat. These are Chuari or Basodan with a height of 8,000 feet, Kali Nali between Mahla and Raipur with a height of 8,900 feet, Mahli between Mahla and Tundi at a height of 8,600 feet and Loa between Mahla and Bhatti Tikri with 10,500 feet. Except for the Chuari pass which is crossed over by a mule track, the others are practical only for men and goats and sheep. While on the move, these shepherds and owners of flocks travel very lightly. Few personal belongings are kept. Except for the dress which is on at the start of journey, little or spare clothes are

carried. Legs remain bare and a *cholā* and *dora* alongwith the cap is all the shepherd is dressed in on these marches. Then of course, he may have a *jarelu*—made out of goats hair for his feet.

The women accompany them and are dressed as usual. For bedding they may have one or two *pattus* which would be of thick wool and are kept tied around the waist. A few utensils, a *hooka* and a *khalru* full of maize flour, some salt, chillies and occasionally some pulses are carried. These men have become so much used to the hard nomadic life, their job entails that to sleep in the open under a cloudy sky is a common habit for them. Whenever it rains, they just look up for some projected rock or a cave shelter and can pass the night leisurely huddled together. Generally the sides of a river or *nullahs* are selected to pass the night. Possibly that is due to the closeness of water.

During the period that is spent in the plains, they take to a number of jobs apart from grazing the flocks. Once a while their women folk work as maid-servants and to see them pounding the paddy is common enough. Men work mostly as labourers on the farms. In this way they accumulate some cash. In the course of journey, some business is also conducted.

A Gaddi is an astute business man and would part with his goat and sheep only when a satisfactory bargain is struck.

I am reminded of the words of a Gaddi shepherd near about Gehra—He with his 6 hundred goats or so, and me in the Deputy Commissioner's Jeep—Being thoroughly annoyed with himself—his sheep, and a nasty stare at me, he had a simple but very philosophic remark to make, "In all these years wherever I have taken my sheep, no matter what route I chose Government has improved and made a better road or is intending that—And behold—this old beaten track—below these rocks was our beaten track for centuries a jeep has started plying—God only knows what happens next. I and my sheep seem to be precursor of all road development programme."

The seasonal migration has effect on the economic and social life of the village. Cash is brought back into the anaemic economy of the village and the slightly enhanced spending power of the people enables them to have a few necessities of life. This in turn, gives encouragement to the petty grocers to enlarge the scope of their little business. Migration leads to a number of other consequences as well. Non-availability of food grains is the ill effect of the migratory habits rather than the cause of it. The people migrate during October, November and return from April to June; *kharif* crop is harvested in a hurry as the passes have to be crossed over before winter sets in. Again, due to the late arrival, *rabi* crop is sown without much regard being paid to the levelling and manuring of fields. Besides, much of period is taken unnecessarily in the journey. On the social side, change of ideas takes place and consequently superstitions yield place to a slight change in the approach towards life. These villagers are developing interest in their children's education which is confirmed by the small kids running to school every morning. The traditional dress is being discarded by the new generation.

Dress

The dress worn by Gaddis is distinct from that worn in the plains and is "Characteristic and striking" in its varied aspects. Generally they use the woollen garments because of the cold climate but in summer cotton clothes can also be used. Traditional dresses continue to be worn and a mythological importance is attached to them. They hold the belief that Lord Shiva also used the same type of dress. There is no distinction of dress as between the castes. On occasion of mournings, only the coloured clothes are avoided. Otherwise this remains unchanged.

Dora—It forms an indispensable part of the dress used both by men and women. Apparently it is an attractive woollen tassel 15 to 25 yards long. Made of sheep's wool, it is black in colour. This is tied round the waist.

Men's Dress

Head Dress—The head dress for men is of a peculiar shape with a flap round the margin and a peak like projection in the centre. The peak is believed to represent the Kailash of Mani Mahesh—an abode of Lord Shiva and as such rightly depicts the religious sentiments of the Gaddis. The flap is tied up for ordinary wear but let down over the ears and neck in times of mourning and also in the severe weather. This style of head dress is falling into disuse and even an ceremonial occasions it is being replaced by the *pagdi* or a woollen *topa* which may be slightly embroidered.

Cholda—On the body a *pattu* forming a sort of a coat, known as *chola* is worn. This reaches below the knees having deep collars which hang loose in two lappets in front, various articles such as needle, thread and

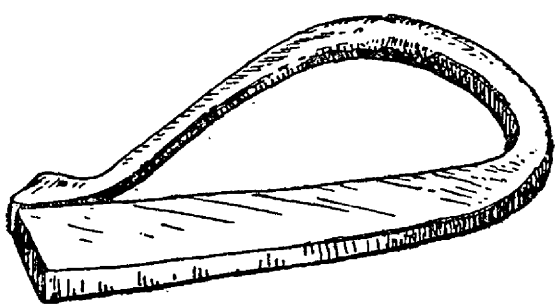
pieces of paper are tucked away in it. The *chola* is tightened round the waist by *dora* of many yards.

The *chola* may consume as much as 20 yards of cloth as the front and parts lengthwise from the centre are kept deliberately loose. *Chola* with some glass tinsels or coloured embroidery are used on festive occasions.

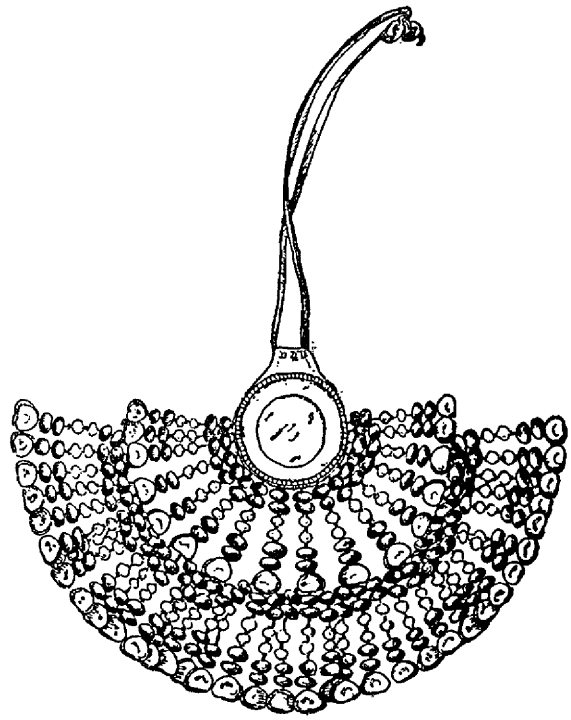
From the girdle there hangs a knife, a *runka* for striking a light, and a *mandua* in which his money and other small articles of every-day requirements are carried. Dangling from the *dora* there may be a cheap round looking glass adorned with *rattis*. This is called *gharat* and the *jhalar* that hangs down below the mirror is *Chhatta*.



Mandua

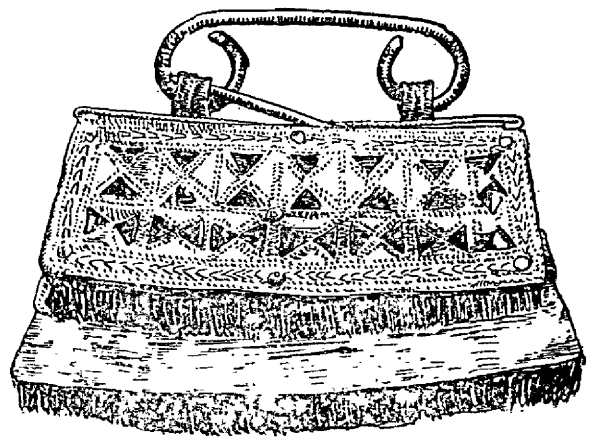


Runka



Chatta

Khukh—The upper portion above the waist is called *khukh*. Being loose it provides space to keep many articles of daily requirement. A shepherd on the move may have four or five newly born lambs stowed away in this space, meals tied up in an untanned leather pouch, a similar pouch full of tobacco, a flint, a knife, a flute and another pouch having tinder for lighting up the fire are all tucked up in the *dora*. Now the flint and the tinder are being replaced by the match box.



Runka

Woollen Pyjama—Some men put on *pattu* pyjamas loose up to the knees but fitting slightly tighter at the lower part of the leg and ankle where it rests in a number of folds.

Women's Dress

The Gaddi women wear a gown to the ankles, and round the waist is the woollen cord or *dora*. Some thing like what men use.

Ghundu—Head dress, cotton or silken scarf in varied shades is used commonly. The shades may be yellow, orange, or pinkish but the crimson is popular. The border is beautifully done with glittering little stars or half moons.

Kameez—A simple shirt is with a half belt to the front. The cut and shape is similar to what men use, except for a slight difference in the fall.

Luanchadi or Paswaj—It is like the garment *chola* which has been explained and covers all the parts of body from shoulders to the ankles. In shape it may be compared to a big and loose shirt. It is, however, made of cotton and consumes cloth varying from 16 to 25 yards with a width of 3 feet. To hold the *luanchadi* tight at the waist a *dora* of lesser length is used.

The difference between the *luanchadi* and *paswaj* lies in the simplicity. *Paswaj* is made of cotton cloth in flowery designs.

Suthni—Many women use *pattu* pyjamas called *suthnis*.

Foot-wear—*Mochdi* are the shoes in common use. Chamba chappal is also common with them. These may be purchased at Chamba while migrating to the plains.

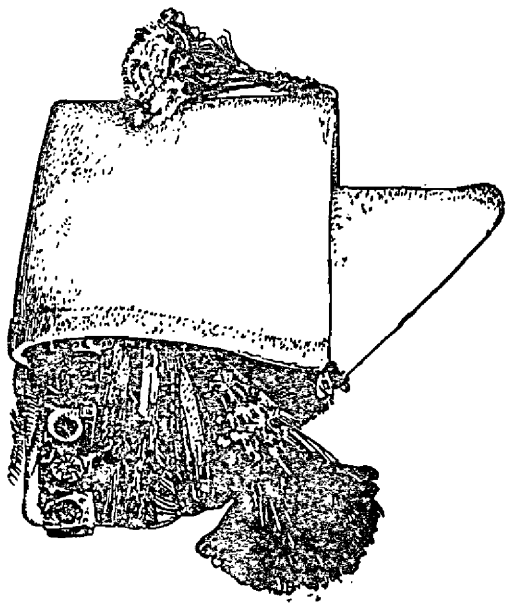
Jarelu—Made of rough goat hair. Used for crossing the snowy passes during the winter.

Change in the Dresses

Changes in the dress are making gradual inroads among the Gaddis and others. The main factor is the opening of interim roads and more officials getting posted in these areas. Education is playing a part in bringing about this change. Receptivity is more pronounced among the youngsters. A majority of boys go bare headed. It is no longer considered a social inhibition.

The modern type of rubber and leather footwear are used to some extent. They are however not easily available in the vicinity and are purchased from Chamba. Some like the hiking shoes, a taste developed because of their durability to stand the rough paths. Women have started wearing fancy Nylon chappals and some of them wear them occasionally. Pull-overs has an added attraction for the villagers and many are using them. *Chola* is being gradually replaced by an ordinary coat, *luanchari* by *salwar*, and the traditional cap either by *pagri* or Gandhi cap of both cotton and woollen. The school going children go to the school in their striped pyjamas and ordinary *kameez* with coat on. Bush-shirt and trousers are making a gradual appearance.

Dresses for Festival—Oracles or *chelas* as they are called put on caps with their fronts reversed with a garland of dried flowers, a tuft of feathers or a string of red beads. The professional dancers have this tuft of feathers tucked up in the fronts of their turbans. Otherwise their traditional dress remains unchanged. They would add some pieces of silk cloth or scarves falling on both sides of the neck upto the waist.



Shopping

Both men and women purchase rough mill made cloth and handloom cotton cloth from the local shopkeepers from Ghera, a bus terminus 4 miles from the village. As for woollen clothes, *pattu* is generally woven in the village. Every household prepares the *pattu* for its requirements of clothing by spinning and weaving of raw wool, obtained either from their own sheep or from Brahmaur. For weaving *pattu* most of the households possess hand-looms fitted in the floor of the *oberi*. The general difficulty which is experienced by the villages is the shortage of raw wool.

There are two persons who stitch the garments for the villagers. One of them is Arya and the other a Gaddi Brahmin, the younger brother of one of the grocers. He sits in the same shop. They have brand new sewing machines along with all the accessories required for the tailoring business. Immediately before the Shiv-Shakti fair they have to face a heavy rush of business. To dispose of the business, mostly relatives are engaged. The stitching charges are:—

1. Chola Cotton . . .	Rs. 6·50
2. Chola Woollen . . .	Rs. 9·50
3. Kameez . . .	Re. 0·75 to Rs. 1/-
4. Coat for Children . . .	Rs. 3/- to 3·50
5. Gents Coat . . .	Rs. 6/- to 7/-
6. Pattu Pyjama . . .	Re. 1/-
7. Cotton Pyjama . . .	Re. 0·50
8. Cap . . .	Re. 0·19

Ornaments

Love for jewellery in this part is proverbial. Mostly the silver ornaments are worn. There is no particular caste distinction as to the use of gold or silver. If the scheduled caste can afford the luxury of gold ornaments there is no opposition whatsoever from the upper castes. Economy is the sole deciding factor.

The pattern of the ornaments is old, heavy and traditional. The modern influence of using lighter ornaments has not affected them. A goldsmith from district Kangra has settled here permanently. The Kangra influence in the pattern of ornaments used by the Gaddi women is distinctly there. During my visit when the Chitrari fair was on, Jewellers from Kangra, Tandi, Palampur, all came here after spending a few days in the Brahmaur *yatra.*

Ornaments for the Head

Chaunk—This is a bowl sort of silver ornament which is fastened on the head. Generally it weighs 6 to 10 tolas.

Chiri—It is a silver ornament fastened to the hair by a chain connected to a flat round silver sheet studded with beautiful immitation pearls. The flat round silver sheet falls on the forehead. The weight of the ornament is 6 to 8 tolas.

Clip—Silver ornament fastened to the hair just above the ears, by means of a pin which is a part of the ornament. This weighs 1 to 2 tolas.



Chiri

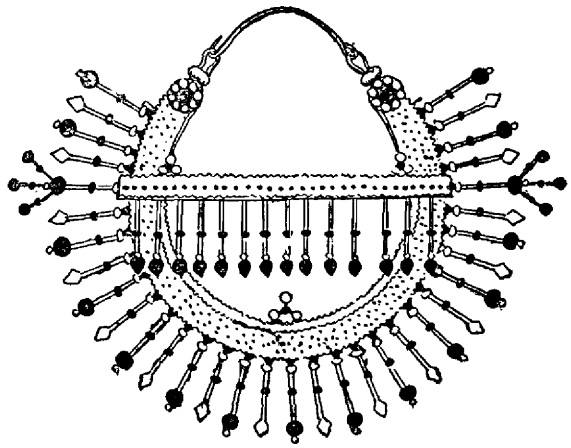
Ornaments for the Ear

Pher—These are ordinary type of ear-rings and may be made either of gold or silver. The weight ranges from 5 to 6 *tolas.*

Balis—These are golden ear-rings and may weigh 3 to 6 *tolas.*

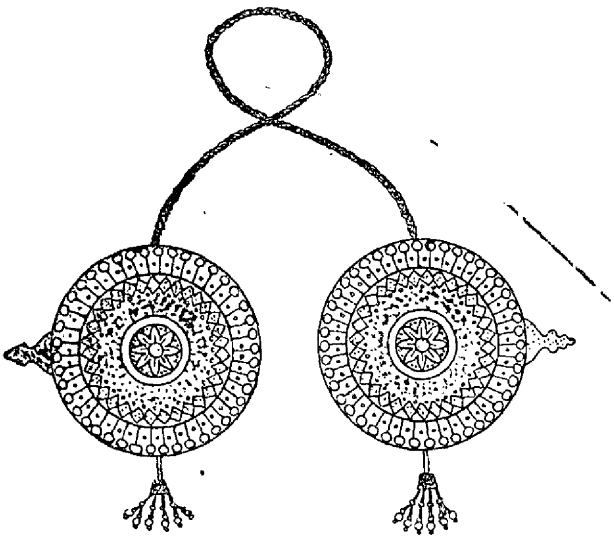
Kanti—Heavy silver or golden ear-rings. Being relatively bigger may weigh as much as 7 to 8 *tolas.*

Kan-Phul—Their shape resembles a bunch of flowers. These are made of silver. Weight is about 1 *tola* per piece.



Kanbale

Dhodku Jhumku—These are two silver tops of big size fastened to chain strings in three or four folds.



Dhodku Jhumku

Nantis—The only gold ornament used by the men are *nantis*. These are small ear-rings and a pair weighs 6 *mashas*.

Sambih—There is only one such ornament and is used by the women for the decoration of their breasts. It is a silver ornament and weighs from 9 to 12 *tolas*.

ORNAMENTS FOR THE NECK

Jo-mala—A silver necklace containing beads weighing 20 to 25 tolas.

Chandan Har—A silver heavy type of necklace weighing 30 to 40 tolas.

Champa Kali—A silver necklace of thin silver cylinders each about 1 inch to 1½ inch in length. Each cylindrical piece is pointed at the ends. There is a hook in the centre and it is tied around the neck by means of thread.

Ralu—This is a silver hollow cylinder bulging out in the centre. It is also tied tightly around the neck. It weighs 1 tola.

ORNAMENTS FOR THE NOSE

Balu—Is a big sized nose ring and is studded with cheap stones or pearls. May weigh from 2 to 3 *tolas*.

Long—Is a gold ornament and resembles a miniature cylinder. May weigh from 3 to 6 *mashas*.

Blak—The ornament is a golden one and suspends from the central wall of the nose, weighs from 2 to 3 *tolas*.

Tilli—Is the smallest nose ornament made of gold and weighs less than a *masha*.

ORNAMENTS FOR THE WRIST

Kangnu—These are round silver bracelets which are hollow from inside. May weigh 8 to 10 *tolas* a pair.

Gajru—Similar to the *kangnu* in shape except for the difference that these are solid from within. Moreover, ends are not joined and are represented usually by the heads of some image of lion. May weigh 15 to 20 *tolas* and are generally made of silver.

Bangas—These are silver bangles and a pair may weigh as much as 4 *tolas*.

Toke—These are flat silver bracelets weighing 15 to 20 *tolas*.

Arsi—Is the silver ring with glass worn on the thumb. This ring may weigh 2 *tolas*. On the other hand, *chhalla* is a gold or silver ring. Usually weighs half *tola*.

Phullus—Are the silver anklets and weigh up to 4 *tolas*.

Among the other ornaments may be included buttons and *moglus* or cuff-links made of silver. These weigh 2 *tolas*. *Moglus* may weigh as much as 4 to 6 *tolas*. Villagers get the images of various gods and goddesses embossed on silver leaves and use these round the neck.

Food Habits

The Gaddis are non-vegetarian and consider no food or drink as tabooed. The idea of beef is resented on religious grounds. The staple food of the people consists of maize chapati with *dal* or *bhujri* although wheat chapaties are also served. The other principal millets are *chinai, phullan, kani, koda* and barley. Rice does not form their daily food and is used on marriages and other festivities.

Pulses form the main part of their daily diet. *Mung, mash, masur, rong* and *kulth* are generally taken with the meals, *mash* forming the principal dish. During rainy season some vegetables like *sarson-ka-sag, brinjals,* bitter gourds, potatoes and pumpkins are grown.

Although every household possesses a cow or two, the average yield per cow is from two to four *chhataks* and that is not sufficient even for tea. The scarcity of milk is there. Every household is fond of tea but do not take it daily. Whenever they happen to suffer from cold or tiredness tea is taken.

Meat is generally taken by every household, the frequency depends upon the means.

Pure *ghee* and mustard oil are used as fats. *Gur* or sugar may be used for preparing tea and sweets.

Fruits are taken once a while. Apart from breakfast meals are taken twice daily. The menu for the day would be:—

		Adults	Children
	Breakfast (Nohari)	chhataks	chhataks
1.	Maize chapati or chapati made of maize flour mixed either with wheat or barley flour.	3 to 4	2
2.	Pulses or vegetables	1	½
	Lunch		
1.	Boiled rice or Chinai-ka-bhat or Maize chapati or chapaties made of flour mixed either with wheat or barley flour	3 to 4 Do. 4 to 6 6 to 8	2 to 3 Do. 1 to 2 4
2.	Pulses or vegetables	1½ to 2	1
	Dinner		
1.	Chinai-ka-bhat or maize chapaties or wheat chapaties or chapaties made of the flour consisting either of barley koda or bharais. The flour can also be mixed with wheat or maize flour.	3 to 4 4 to 6 Do.	2 to 3 3 Do.

NOTE—The maize chapaties may weigh as much as 2 *chhataks* whereas the chapaties made either of wheat flour or mixed one weighs 1½ *chhataks*.

Some typical dishes prepared in the Gaddi households on the occasion of festivities, have their own characteristics.

Bobroos—Sugar is added to taste in the wheat flour. A thin paste is prepared. This paste is poured into *ghee* or mustard oil in bits.

Luchi—These are small, thin and round and made of wheat in *ghee*.

Halwa—Is a type of pudding. Wheat, *maida* or *suji* is fried in the *ghee* and water is mixed afterwards with sugar.

Chinghi—A food unique by itself and consumed during winter. *Seul* is roasted and mixed with boiled *ghandeli*. Then salt and chillies are added to taste. The persons well-off roast the *seul*, the others just mix the *seul* in raw form with boiled *ghandeli*.

Ghandelis are dried and stored to be consumed in winter. Whenever the villagers feel shortage of food grains, they resort to this.

Chhalli-ka-laddu—Another speciality lies in the balls made of maize flour which are boiled. Afterwards *ghee*, salt, chillies and spices are added to taste.

Kainth—This is a tree found in the hills and yield a fruit which is bigger than *ber*. Elsewhere in the Pradesh the fruit is considered quite useless. In Chitrari, the villagers collect the fruit and dry it in the sun. After that it is mixed with maize and then ground into flour.

Beverages

People would like to have tea. Even the relatively well-off persons consider it a luxury to have tea daily. The guests are served invariably with a cup or a bowl. As against this, *sur* is a traditional beverage and the villagers are very fond of it. Occasions like marriages and festivals are incomplete if *sur* is not served. It is a home-made brew and at the most may be compared to a light form of beer. The Excise Department issues regular permits for having this keeping in view, of course, the customs of the people and climate of the region. The nearest wine shop is at Gehra—a bus terminus four miles away from the village. Some of the villagers occasionally visit the shop. What horrible sights and disgusting scenes are enacted near some of these—the less said the better.

The process of *sur* preparation is essentially crude. *Bhoot-kesi* a wild root found in the jungles is dried in the sun and turned into a thin powder. The powder is mixed with barley flour and after being fermentated for sometime, it is kneaded. Thick loaves are prepared and stored for the occasion whenever the *sur* is to be prepared. This is the basic raw material in the whole process of preparation.

Kodra cakes are put into a pitcher full of water where loaves of the basic raw material are added and allowed to ferment for about a week. *Sur* is light brown when it is ready to be served. Men and women take it freely, some in moderate quantities and others to their capacity. The effect is moderate on those who take in small quantities. However, it tends to induce intoxication if gulped in larger quantities. People attach religious importance to *sur* and serve it as *charnamrit* in the name of Shiv-Shakti on the occasion of festival or *yatra*.

Smoking

It is very common. Except for the old ones, the other women do not generally smoke. Gaddis are always found with a *hukka*. Tobacco is grown and blended in the village.

The diet is unbalanced and the people definitely suffer from malnutrition and are underfed. Vitamins which are most essential, are seldom present in their diet. Milk, eggs, fish and fruits are just a dream.



An old Gaddi with hukka

Utensils

Cooking utensils and other vessels used in preparing food are made of brass, bronze and aluminium. The aluminium utensils are preferred more due to their being light as the Gaddis are a migratory population. A few others are made of iron. Earthen pitchers and *handiyas* are found in every household. All metallic utensils are procured from outside the village mostly from Chamba and Shahpur. Purchases are made at Shahpur as some migrate to this side during winter. Earthen vessels are procured from Koonr, a neighbouring village. There is no potter in Chitrari. The type of utensils used are:—

Utensils	Metal Used	Purpose for which used
Balti	Iron-Brass	Buckets for fetching or storing water.
Karahi	Iron	Frying pan.
Tatwan	Iron	A pitcher to heat water.
Baltaoi	Brass	Pitcher for storing water.
Chamru	Brass-Aluminium	Big mouthed pitcher to heat water.
Bhaddu	Brass	Round utensil with heavy bottom and narrow mouth used for cooking pulses.
Patilu	Brass-Aluminium	Used for prepari g vegetables or pulses.
Bunta	Brass	Vessel for storing water.
Glass	Brass	Tumbler
Karchhi	Brass-Gilt	Ladle
Lotu/Garbi	Brass	For putting and drinking water.
Tamshu	Brass	Pitcher-shaped utensil for preparing pulses.
Katoru	Aluminium Bronze-Brass	Bowls for serving pulses or vegetables.
Thalu	Brass-Bronze	A round plate for serving the meal.
Paratdu	Wood-Brass-Copper	Wide trough for kneading flour into dough.
Kunala	Wood	Hand-washing basin.
Pagi	Earthen	A small pitcher-shaped vessel for turning the unboiled milk into curd.
Bilda	Earthen receptacle	Storing water.
Maghi	Earthen	A pitcher of small size.

Besides, there are such utensils as a pair of tongs, *sansi* and *tawa* which are made of iron and are very common. *Chakla-belan* are the other common articles of daily use.

Household Goods

The articles of furniture as they are understood in the modern sense are not common here. Even cots which form a comfort are possessed only by ten per cent of the families. On an average, a household may have not more than two cots or charpoys. These are served to the guests as they themselves generally sleep on the ground. The beddings used by them are only a collection of old clothes sewed together and a few blankets.

Manjri—Is very popular with them and are made of wheat straw. Every household may have a number of them. During winter these are spread out on the ground to have a protection against the cold. Otherwise also these are used the year round.

Apart from a few well-off families, tables, stools, and benches are not possessed by them.

To possess radio-set is a dream here. The Panchayat Department has arranged for a radio with a battery-set in the village with a loud-speaker fixed up in the shop of the Gram Panchayat President. As far as watches are concerned, only four persons in the village possess them. There is a gramophone. Every household has on an average, four or five wooden boxes, one or two tin boxes and one or two wooden almirahs. These are used to keep the jewellery, garments and odds and ends.

Peiru—Is a local name for a big storing vessel made of bamboo with a diameter of about 2 feet and plastered from inside with cowdung. Used for storing food-grains.

Toon—A little variation in the construction of *peiru* is known as *toon* used for the same purpose.

Kuli—Earthen-made vessels used for storing grains. These are brought from the lower hills or plains.

Birth Rituals

Pregnancy—The concept of pregnancy is not marked by way of restrictions on the movements which a woman is to undergo. Women continue to do their odd jobs. They fetch water and work in the fields. Some rituals and certain acts are gone through. When a woman becomes pregnant she sets aside four copper coins and her necklace in the name of *kailu*, who is the spirit of abortion. This is taken to mean the appeasement of the deity.

As a matter of practice, delivery takes place in *oberi*. In the one roomed houses, the expectant mother is segregated in a corner and a screen is put up to preserve the privacy. A local *dai* or more commonly the old and experienced women of the village assist. It is not necessary for them to have a bath after conducting the child-birth. Dhano, an Arya woman is sent for whenever delivery cases are to be attended. The rates charged by her are Rs. 2/- in the case of a male birth and only one rupee if a girl is born. The assistance of Midwife employed by the Child and Maternity Welfare Centre is taken. Villagers are however, still a little shy. The Midwife has attended to three cases in Chitrari so far. The birth of the male child is considered auspicious and message is sent to the mother's parents. He is paid some *gur* and a rupee coin.

About two or three months after the delivery the *purohit* and the women worship the demon *kailu* under a *kainth* tree. This is done by setting up a big stone which is consecrated by the recitation of *mantras* and then worshipped. A white goat or a white one with a black head, is offered. An incision is made in the right ear with a *kati* or knife. The blood that oozes out of the incision is sprinkled on the consecrated stone and a piece of pinkish cloth which may be two and half yard in length tied round it. The goat offered to the *kailu* demon is now considered sacred and is allowed to die a natural death. After it has died, to eat its meat is considered a taboo. The woman tastes a bit of *gur* and then puts on the cloth. This cloth is used till it is completely worn out and then a new one is made and worn after performing the same ceremony. A goat and the four coins which were kept aside when the woman first showed signs of pregnancy are made over to the owner of the goat.

Food for the mother—Care is taken to help the mother recoupe her energy. She is fed on the nourishing diet for one month. *Sugra* is a unique food made of rice, milk and sugar and this is common. It is more or less similar to *khir*. Next comes *chhavani*—mixture of almonds, *chhuara*, *dakh* and coconut crushed together with *gur*, *ajwain* and fried in *ghee*. This particular item is a must and every family gives it to the new mother. The baby is to taste the *gur* and an all famous *ghuti* consisting of *bansalochan*, *nagauri-asgand* and *kamarkas* is given to help digestion. The time of the birth is noted and the village priest contacted for the preparation of the horoscope if the household concerned is well-off otherwise it is avoided. New clothes are given to the *purohits* by a few of them.

Gauntar—The ceremony is called *gauntar* because cow's urine is important throughout. The rituals are performed after 5 days in the case of girl and either on the seventh or tenth day, if a boy is born. The mother's clothes are washed and the house cleaned and mixture of *gomutra*, milk and *ganga-jal* thrown over the clothes and sipped by all; who belong to the family. Then they go to the *purohit* to ask him about the child's future. A few rupees are paid. In case child was not born under happy stars then charms are put on the child. In case the tidings are inauspicious then they tie *ashtdhatoo*, *satyara* and *surajgrah*.

The mother is not to enter the kitchen and touch household articles till the *sutak* lasts.

Out of a total population of 404 persons 211 are workers and 193 non-workers. Out of these non-workers 158 are covered by the age group 0—14. This is quite natural as they are not doing any productive work. In the age group 15—34 there are 45 female workers against only 19 non-workers which only shows that the women-folk assist men in the agricultural operations. Even the 19 female non-workers are housewives as they are engaged either in the household work or in spinning the wool. The 4 male non-workers in the age group 15—34 are not employed regularly. As and when available, they do some work either as labourers or coolies. It would be more correct to classify them as partial workers in place of non-workers as partially they are dependent upon their relatives. In the age group 60 and above no male has been returned as non-worker. The number of female non-workers falling in the age group 60 and above is 5 out of a total of 6. As the nature of the work which they do is essentially arduous and exhaustive, they are no longer helpful at this age to undertake these odd jobs.

We may now give two more tables showing the workers classified by sex, broad age-groups and occupations, and workers classified by sex, broad-age group and industry, business and cultivation.

Age Group	Agriculture			Shopkeeping			Goldsmithy			Govt. Service			Labour		
	P	M	F	P	M	F	P	M	F	P	M	F	P	M	F
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16
All ages . . .	191	112	79	3	3	..	3	3	..	13	13	..	1	1	..
0—14	8	5	3	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..
15—34	106	61	45	2	2	..	2	2	..	10	10	..	1	1	..
35—59	68	38	30	1	1	..	1	1	..	3	3	..	..	..	..
60 and over . . .	9	8	1	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..

Age Group	Workers engaged in											
	Total workers			Household Industry			Household Business			Household cultivation		
	P	M	F	P	M	F	P	M	F	P	M	F
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13
All ages . .	211	132	79	5	3	2	3	3	..	213	126	87
0—14 . .	8	5	3	..	..	..	..	..	..	8	5	3
15—34 . .	121	76	45	3	2	1	2	2	..	122	72	50
35—59 . .	73	43	30	2	1	1	1	1	..	74	41	33
60 & over . .	9	8	1	..	..	..	..	..	..	9	8	1

Leaving aside the age-group 60 and over it is apparent that women work side by side with the men. It is all due to the fact that after having crossed this age-limit of 60 and over women do not remain fit to undertake the arduous jobs which agriculture involves. In the age-groups 15—34 and 35—59 although the male workers out-number, but it proves our contention, that women do not lag behind the men in sharing the work of cultivation This clearly shows that women have an equal responsibility in building the rural economy. Except for ploughing they handle all the jobs associated with agricultural operations. Barring the work of labourer, women do other work. In the former case it is considered a social taboo to work as coolies. We may thus sum up the position by concluding that women are essentially over-worked. Apart from cultivation they have also to attend to the domestic chores. The villagers are aware of this fact and take it as a matter of tradition.

Coming to the Government service we find that in all there are 13 such persons. Two of them are working as peons and one as a teacher in the local school others are local inhabitants. The remaining persons are outsiders and work in various capacities in the Government institutions. Only recently a child welfare centre has been opened which employs two women workers, one of them is a Lady Health Visitor and the other a Midwife. Apart from this two girls are working as school teachers. These 4 cases have not been accounted for in the census survey as these employees were posted afterwards. No female is engaged in professions such as shopkeeping, tailoring, goldsmithy and in carpentry. One significant feature emerges from the study of these facts. Except for dealing in general merchandize, all other vocations are being pursued by all castes side by side with the *swarns*. It has been observed that there are innumerable instances when a man with agriculture as his primary occupation works occasionally as a labourer. The latter may therefore, be termed as his subsidiary occupation.

Non Workers

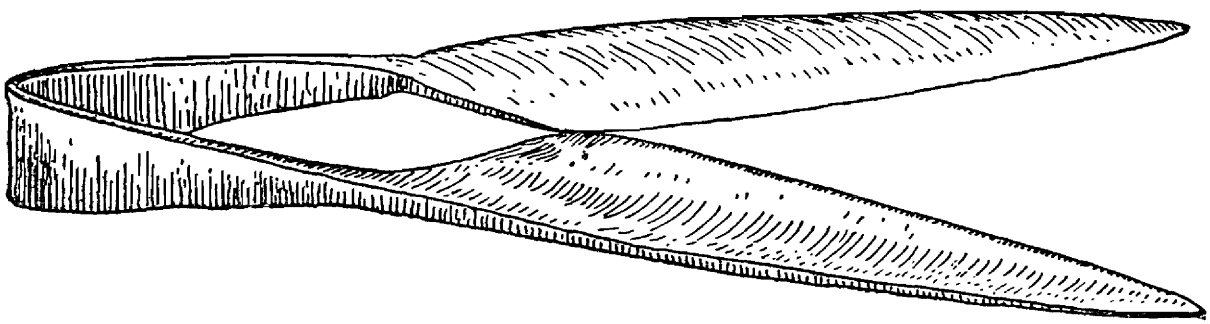
Age Groups	Total Non-workers			Full time students or children attending school			Persons engaged only in household duties			Dependents, infants and children not attending school and persons permanently disabled			Persons seeking employment for the first time		
	P	M	F	P	M	F	P	M	F	P	M	F	P	M	F
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16
All ages . . .	193	72	121	31	19	12	23	..	23	139	53	86	..	..	..
0—14	158	68	90	30	18	12	..	..	..	128	50	78	..	..	..
15—34	23	4	19	1	1	..	17	..	17	5	3	2	..	..	..
35—59	7	..	7	..	..	..	5	..	5	2	..	2	..	..	..
60 & over . . .	5	..	5	..	..	..	1	..	1	4	..	4	..	..	..

Full time students in the age-group 0—14 years are 18 males and 12 females whereas in the age-group 15—34 there is only one male student. Persons engaged in the household duties are all females and their number is 23. Naturally enough the infants and children not attending school are covered by the age-group 0—14. The numerical composition is 53 males and 86 females. Every adult male or female is engaged in one or the other occupation as is apparent from the above table. There is no person who is seeking employment. In the age-group 35—59 and 60 and above there is no male person who is dependent. However, there are 6 female persons—2 are covered by the age-group 35—59 and 4 by the 60 and above who are dependent in one way or the other. Possibly it is all due to the advance age which has rendered them incapable to undertake arduous jobs.

Rural Crafts

Weaving

Weaving is common. The wool is procured from the domestic sheep. The sheep are sheared in April-May, August-September and lastly in December-January.



Shearing Scissors

Thobis and ropes are prepared for Zilan. The raw wool is dyed fast into the pink and black colours which are popular in Chitrari. *Alum* is used to make fast colours.

The spinning is done by the traditional *takli* and the spinning wheel, the traditional devices which continue to be in vogue. These are prepared by the village carpenters. *Takli* is also known as *batnu* or *heran*. The Gaddis are adept in spinning that for hours together and the thread does not break. The quality of the material spun is fine.

Different varieties of blankets and *pattis*, *gardus* and *chaddars* are woven. From the woollen *patti*, *chola* pyjama and *cholee* are made for women. The *pattis* are woven in pieces of three yards each. When the piece is completed it is washed in the hot water and *rithas*. The price ranges from Rs. 10 to Rs. 20.

The loom is fixed in the main room of the house and is called *toni*. This is a wooden structure. The *kanghhi* is brought either from Chamba or Shahpur and this costs Rs. 3. The remaining structure is put up locally by the carpenters. The other prominent tools are *nal* and *tenthi*.

The patterns are simple and popular, squares in black alternated with squares in brown with a border in pink.

Weaving and Training Centre

Realizing that spinning and weaving have a scope for improvement and also to utilize more effectively the wool produced in the area, Government have opened recently a Weaving and Training Centre at Chitrari. This was established on 1st June 1963 and is functioning since then. The staff of the institution consists of a Weaving Master Incharge, Weaving Master and a peon-cum-chowkidar with a strength of four boys and two girls on the rolls. The sanctioned strength is 8. The specific purpose of the institution is to impart training both to the boys and girls within an area of 14 miles. So trained, they are enabled to establish themselves independently, and earn a living. The Centre gives the training both in woollen and cotton weaving.

The centre is housed in private building which has been rented. Ten *khadis* are fixed. Training is given on the following weaves.

1. Plain weaves.
2. Twill weaves (different kinds).
3. Flowered weaves.
4. Extra warp and waft weaves,
5. Double clothe weaves.

The training course is of 12 months duration for which stipends are given at these rates.

Rs. 30 for the first 4 months.

Rs. 20 plus the wages for the following four months.

Rs. 15 plus the wages for the remaining period of 4 months.

The difficulty lies in the migratory character of the population. Many do not join the training for the fear that in the mid-course, they may leave. However, soon this inhibiting factor would disappear.

The weaving charges for a shawl are from Rs. 16 to Rs. 40 and the charges for embroidering the flowers is Re. 1 per inch. If the design of the flower is simple, the rate may be Re. 0.50 per inch. Both simple and designed blankets are prepared here on the cotton side. *Khaddar* is quite popular. The goods are disposed of through the Government Emporium at Chamba. It was disclosed that the shawls in green, red and blue with black line are quite popular with the town folks.

One more practice to help the trainees financially after the course is over lies in deducting their stipend at the rate Rs. 10 every month. The entire sum is repaid to them in a lump sum after the completion of their course to enable them to purchase the implements and raw material.

Goldsmithy

There is one shop of goldsmith who caters to the ornament requirements of the people both of Chitrari and from the neighbouring villages. He has hired a shop belonging to the Shiv-Shakti Temple at a rent of Rs. 10 annually. The shop is a *kacha* structure with dimensions of 18′ × 12′ × 12′. Metaphorically it is a focal point of womenfolk who can be seen frequently passing in front of the shop fixing their eyes upon the almirah. The samples of the ornaments are hung against the background of the transparent coloured papers. Apart from being a dealer in his trade, he is a vital link who communicates fresh ideas to the people. He remains permanently in touch with Chamba and Amritsar and very often visits these places in connection with the procurement of gold and silver and the tools of manufacture. Following is the list of the tools used here—

1. Airan (Anvil).
2. Hammer.
3. Nal (Mouth blower).

agriculture. The single household of Badhi also falls in this category which shows craftsmanship is a paying profession.

Expenditure

The statement on expenditure is also roughish and has been worked out caste-wise and income-wise. It presents a pattern giving us a clue as to the trends of people's expenditure. Items like food, clothing and education have been shown separately whereas under others smoking, medical, social ceremonies, cultivation and land revenue have been grouped together.

Food—Food grains are produced in the farm. This invariably is just sufficient to meet their own requirements. As a result nothing is left by way of marketable surplus. A major portion of the income calculated at the prevailing market rates, is spent on food.

Serial No.	Items of Expenditure	Household with a monthly income of: Upto Rs. 50 — No of Households	Upto Rs. 50 — Average Expenditure	Rs. 51—100 — No. of Households	Rs. 51—100 — Average Expenditure	Rs. 101 and above — No. of Households	Rs. 101 and above — Average Expenditure
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
	Average Monthly expenditure per Brahman Household by Income Groups						
1	Food	40	19·13	13	48·35	7	73·85
2	Clothing	40	4·28	13	11·86	7	32·85
3	Education	12	1·67	2	2·60	4	5·60
4	Other	40	3·64	13	8·15	7	30·28
	Average Monthly Expenditure per Rajput Household by Income Groups						
1	Food	4	27·25	2	39·59	..	..
2	Clothing	4	4·75	2	10·41	..	..
3	Education	..	..	..	..	..	..
4	Other	4	3·25	2	5·16	..	..
	Average Monthly Expenditure per Khatri Household by Income Groups						
1	Food	..	..	..	..	2	74·80
2	Clothing	..	..	..	..	2	22·75
3	Education	..	..	..	..	2	4·50
4	Others	..	..	..	..	2	2·48
	Average Monthly Expenditure per Badhi Household by Income Groups						
1	Food	..	..	..	..	..	..
2	Clothing	..	..	..	..	..	..
3	Education	..	..	..	..	..	..
4	Others	..	..	..	..	..	..
	Average Monthly Expenditure per Arya Household by Income Groups						
1	Food	1	16·00	1	41·00	..	..
2	Clothing	1	5·00	1	12·00	..	..
3	Education	..	..	..	..	..	..
4	Others	1	5·00	1	6·00	..	..
	Average Monthly Expenditure by Bensi Household by Income Groups						
1	Food	7	24·00	2	58·00	..	..
2	Clothing	7	5·21	2	11·60	..	..
3	Education	..	..	..	..	..	..
4	Others	7	4·14	2	5·50	..	..

Clothing—Villagers spend little on clothing.

Education—A little expenditure is incurred on education as not all the households have their children studying in the school. Besides the tuition charges are normal. Whatever little expenditure they have to incur is on books, and stationery articles.

Others—The expenditure on items grouped under the heading 'others' grows with a progressive rise in income. On the whole the villagers do not have to spend more on these items as the range of their incomes is limited. The people in service who are mostly from the urban areas spend relatively more.

Indebtedness

Average income being low, people are not spendthrift. Their agricultural production is not sufficient even for eight months in a year and have, therefore, to purchase the foodgrains from the neighbouring villagers who have had some surplus to spare. The agencies which cater to their requirement of loans include the petty shopkeepers of the village and nearby places, and also a few well-to-do *zamindars*. The cooperative society is not much popular with them although it meets their financial requirements to some extent. The rate of interest charged by the private agencies is exorbitant as the element of risk involved is greater. The rate may be put at 15 to 20 per cent. The loans are sometimes incurred for litigation, house construction and repairs, marriage and also in a few cases for pilgrimage. Under miscellaneous wants we may put performance of religious rites and day to day requirements like consumption items. The following table gives an idea about the number of persons in debt distributed according to the income ranges:—

Indebtedness by Income Group

Income Group	Total No. of house-holds	No. of house-holds in debt	Percentage of Col. 3 to Col. 2
1	2	3	4
Rs. 25 and below . .	17	11	64%
Rs. 26 to 50 . .	35	18	51%
Rs. 51 to 75 . .	6	1	16%
Rs. 76 to 100 . .	12	6	50%
Rs. 101 & over . .	10	3	30%
	80	39	

In the income range 25 and below we may attribute the highest percentage to the low income but this contention is disproved by the succeeding ranges. Even in the range Rs. 101 and above there are as many as 30 per cent cases of debts. The causes which induce the people to incur the loans would be clear from the table.

Land Utilization Statement of Village Chitrari (in Bighas)

Year	Total Forests Area	Not available for cultivation: Barren and Unculturable Land	Not available for cultivation: Land put to Non-Agricultural Uses	Not available for cultivation: Total 3 & 4	Other uncultivated land excluding current fallows: Culturable waste	Other uncultivated land excluding current fallows: Permanent and other Lands	Other uncultivated land excluding current fallows: Pastures grazing	Other uncultivated land excluding current fallows: Land under misc. tree crops	Other uncultivated land excluding current fallows: Total 6, 7 & 8
	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9
1955	2652·4	48·0	160·14	..	160·14	45·14	80·16	1586·0	1712·10
1956	2652·4	48·0	160·14	..	160·14	45·14	80·16	1586·0	1712·10
1957	2652·4	48·0	160·14	..	160·14	45·14	80·16	1586·0	1712·10
1958	2652·4	48·0	160·14	..	160·14	45·14	80·16	1586·0	1712·10
1959	2652·4	48·0	N.A.	..	161·7	57·16	80·8	1586·0	1724·4
1960	2652·4	48·0	N.A.	..	161·7	57·16	80·8	1586·0	1724·4
1961	2652·4	48·0	N.A.	..	161·7	57·16	80·8	1586·0	1724·4

Year	Fallow Lands: Current fallows	Fallow Lands: Other fallow land	Fallow Lands: Total 10 & 11	Net area sown	Total cropped area	Area sown more than once	Dhani Awal	Dhani Doom	Dhani Soem	Kalahu Awal	Kalahu Doem	Kalahu Soem
	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	21
1955	N.A.	N.A.	30·14	690·0	935·0	245·0	..	..	..	2·6	..	..
1956	N.A.	N.A.	30·14	690·0	935·0	245·0	..	..	..	2·6	..	..
1957	N.A.	N.A.	30·14	690·0	935·0	245·0	..	..	..	2·6	..	..
1958	N.A.	N.A.	30·14	690·0	935·0	245·0	..	..	..	2·6	..	..
1959	N.A.	N.A.	17·16	690·0	935·0	245·0	..	..	..	2·6	..	..
1960	N.A.	N.A.	17·16	690·0	935·0	255·0	..	..	..	2·6	..	..
1961	N.A.	N.A.	17·16	690·0	935·0	245·0	..	..	..	2·6	..	..

Land Utilization Statement of Village Chitrari (in Bighas)—*contd.*

Year	Bagicha Kalahu	Barani Awal	Barani Doem	Barani Soem	Bagicha Barani	Sailab	Banjar Jadid	Banjar Kadim	Ghalla	Bani	Trakkar
	22	23	24	25	26	27	28	29	30	31	32
1955	..	498·14	219·4	..	0·10	..	..	45·14	1·9	8·17	..
1956	..	498·14	219·4	..	0·10	..	..	45·14	1·9	8·17	..
1957	..	498·14	219·4	..	0·10	..	..	45·14	1·9	8·17	..
1958	..	498·14	219·4	..	0·10	..	..	45·14	1·9	8·17	..
1959	..	491·9	213·11	..	0·10	..	0·11	57·16	1·9	8·17	..
1960	..	491·9	213·11	..	0·10	..	0·11	57·16	1·9	8·17	..
1961	..	491·9	213·11	..	0·10	..	0·11	57·16	1·9	8·17	..

Indebtedness by Causes

Causes	No. of families in debt	Average amount of per bebt household
1	2	3
		Rs.
Litigation . . .	2	1,600
Miscellaneous wants . .	29	283
House construction . .	5	604
Marriage	1	140
Foodgrains . . .	1	600
Pilgrimage . . .	1	100
	39	

Agriculture

Agriculture is the principal occupation of the people. All other occupations are subsidiary and may include sheep and goat rearing, labour and rural industry. The total cultivated area of the village was 690 bighas in 1955-56, the same as in 1960-61. This shows there has been no increase in the cultivated area over these years. The soil is stony and unfertile. There does not seem to be further scope to extend the area of cultivation. Owing to an increase in population and the gradual disappearance of the joint family system, the average size of the holding has been gradually declining.

Mainly due to the inhospitable nature of the terrain, farming in the area is not as much profitable as it is in other parts of Himachal Pradesh. The entire area is non-irrigated. To corroborate our observations we reproduce below a relevant extract from "Farmers of India" by M. S. Randhawa (Chapter XX—Farmers Communities).

"Agriculture in H.P. means subsistence farming. Even so, it hardly suffices for the cultivator's simple needs. A survey carried out in 1950 showed that 48 per cent of the working members of land owners and tenant families pursued some subsidiary occupation to supplement the income from land. The scope for employment as agricultural labour being very little, many of them have taken to rearing of sheep and goats, lumbing in the forests, weaving and selling milk and vegetables."

Land Utilization

From the land utilization statement it is clear that there is no variation from 1955 to 1961 in cultivation. The net area sown is shown in column 13 which is 690 *bighas*. The average cultivated area per *khatoni* holding comes to about 10 *bighas* as there are 70 such cases noted in the village revenue books. Taking into account the allied factors one could say that the holding is definitely uneconomic and explains why the people are eager to take up alternative jobs to supplement their meagre incomes.

Fields

The region is interspersed with craggy precipitous ranges and terraced cultivation is the rule. Village fields are of hard rocks and stones. Levelling and to make it fit for cultivation is a hard job. At the bottom of the slope a wall is raised up from 4 feet to 10 feet sometimes and the top layer broken, until it is formed into a number of terraces by corresponding number of walls. Over and above this, the area often receives the nature's wrath. It is subjected to frequent landslides and thunder storms in the rainy season. In that case the whole terraced fields are damaged and the work started afresh to restore it in its original form.

The villagers spend a major part of their labour, after every rainy season in preparing the soil. Virtually it is a struggle against heavy odds scratching the mountain sides to eke out their existence.

Two crops are raised in a year and the distribution of the cereals and millets as per cropping seasons is:—

Local Name	English Name	Botanical Name
Kharif—		
Kukri	Maize	Zea Mays
Koda	Ragi	Eleusine coracana
Cheena	Cheena	Panicum Miliaceum
Phullan	..	Fagoperum Emarginaturn
Bharis	..	Fagoperum Emarginatum
Scul	..	A masanthus anardana
Kangni (Koni)	A millet variety	Pennisetum Ltalicum
Mash	Kidney beans	Phasio lubridiatus
Moong	Green Gram	Phaseolus Radiatus
Mirch	Chillies	Capsicum aunuum
Tamaku	Tobacco	Nicotiona Tobercum
Rong	..	Dolichos Sineusis
Rabi—		
Kanak	Wheat	Triticum Gehum, Vulgare or Gandam Triticum sertivum
Jou	Barley	Hordeum, Volgare
Sarson	Rape seed	Brassica Napus
Dhan	Rice or Paddy	Oryza Sativa

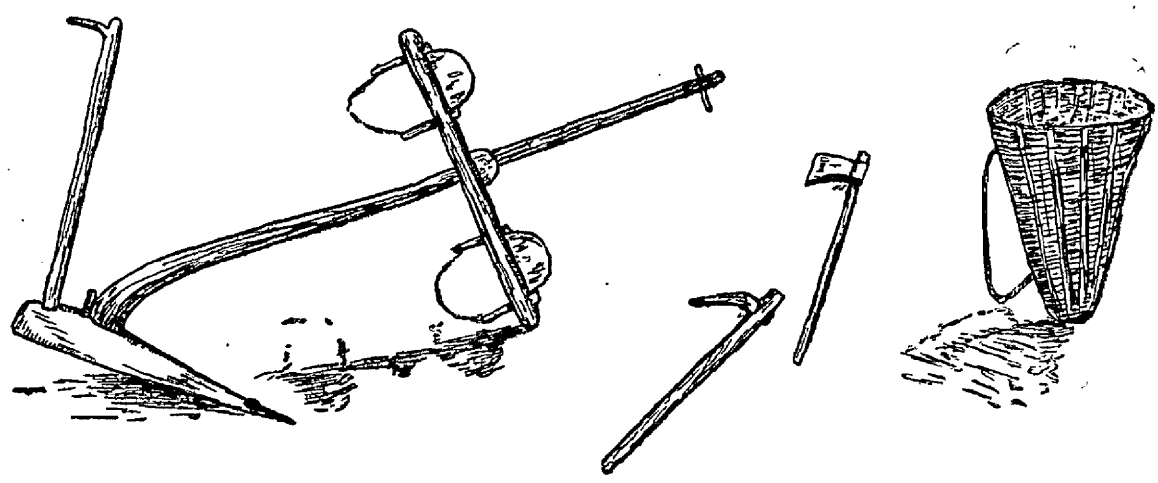
Vegetables—Due to the lack of irrigation facilities vegetables are not grown very much. However, during the moonsoon some grow a few vegetables like brinjals, chillies, bitter gourds, tomatoes, cucumbers and pumpkins for their own consumption. No beginning has been made towards horticulture.

Manuring—Cowdung is the organic manure. This is mixed up with the *deodar* and *kail* leaves and other refuse. This manure is effective in clay and sandy soils. The contents are heaped up either in one corner of the cowshed or the courtyard or in the fields. Since the lands are non-irrigated, the idea of using chemical fertilizers have not found favour with them. There is a general belief prevalent among the people that the use of chemical fertilizer destroys the crops if enough water is not available. The Gram Sewak demonstrates the improved method of preparing manure by digging out the manure pits.

Seeds—A part of the produce is set aside as seeds, after these are dried in the sun. These are stored in *peirus*. There is always the neighbourly goodwill and villagers freely borrow seeds from each other and return them when the crop is harvested.

Storing—Care is taken to store the grains in *peirus* which may be made of bamboos with a diameter of about 2 feet and are plastered with cowdung. A little variation in the construction of *peirus* is known as *toons*. These are also used for storing.

Agricultural Implements—There has been no change in the implements. The form and shape continues to be the same as have been used for many centuries. A list of the implements possessed by agricultural household can be studied from this table.



Plough, kilta and other agricultural implements

Name of Implement: Local	Name of Implement: English	Price	Life	Use
1	2	3	4	5
Hal	Plough	2·00	One to two years	Ploughing.
Phala	Plough-share	5·00	One year	Do.
Kudali	Hoe	4·00	One year	Weeding
Kirad, Kilta	Conical baskets	4·00	Six months	For carrying grains and seeds.
Drati	Sickle	1·50	1½ years	For harvesting.
Khilni	Hoo	1·50	1½ years	For hoeing.
Kulhari	Axe	8·00	2 years	For cutting wood.
Mei	Harrow	6·00	Six months	For making the ground level.
Jungla	Yoke	5·00	Six months	For yoking, cattle.
Rassa	Rope	3·00	One year	For binding purposes.
Hupli	Winnowing fan	1·00	One to two years	For winnowing purposes.

AGRICULTURAL PRACTICES

Kharif Crops

Maize—It is the staple food of the people and is consumed throughout the year. Its over-riding importance is attributed to the fact that the failure of this crop is followed by almost famine conditions. Every care is taken to secure a good crop. Some of the land is kept fallow in the preceding *rabi* season. Having repaired the retaining walls and set in order the terraces of the fields, they get to the work of putting the manures which may be two to three *kiltas* full of cowdung per *bigha*. A *kilta* may contain as much as 20 kilograms of cowdung. Simultaneously with the manuring operations, clearing of pebbles and stone is also carried out. Then the land is ploughed and clods broken with the *khilni*. After a lapse of week or so, again a ploughing is given to the land and it is levelled to be made ready for sowing purposes. The villagers then wait for a mild shower which seldom fails them, and the seed is sown by broadcasting and is followed by a third ploughing. The quantity sown per *bigha* is two and a half seers. The seed starts germinating after ten days and may grow upto a foot within a month. Now the plants are thinned where the growth is thick and the weeding of *baray* and *peepla* plants are done alongwith hoeing with a tool known as *nadani*. When the crop has ripened, usually the women-folk get into the fields with their sickles and the plants are cut from the bottom. The plants are heaped up in one corner of the courtyard where the cobs are removed from the plants. The stalks may be used as fodder. The cobs are spread out on any open space nearabout, generally courtyards and roofs. When completely dried up in the sun, are removed to the *dragras* of the house. Here the grains are extracted from the cobs and then later are stored to be used as fuel.

Cheena—It is a species of millets and is sown in separate plots and the land is kept fallow in the preceding season. Else it is sown after the harvesting of wheat crop by those who do not possess such separate plots. All the preliminary agricultural operations are the same as those in the case of maize. The first and the only hoeing alongwith weeding and thinning of the plants where necessary, is done a month after sowing. At this stage, the plants have grown upto a height of 6 inches or so.

The fields are manured as in the case of maize and the quantity of seeds may be put at a seer per *bigha*. The work of harvesting the crop is generally executed by the women-folk who cut the *sittas* or ears from the plants and go on putting it in the *kiltas*. The *sittas* so collected are transferred to the *dragras* and are stored there. On the sunny days these are spread out in the courtyard and on roofs to be dried in the sun. When completely dried up, thrashing follows which is done with the help of bullocks. They are made to tread over it a number of times till the grains are separated from the *sittas*. The next operation is of removing the husk from the grains and now it is the winnowing fan which comes handy. The operation is preformed by two women. Having filled it with the contents, one of them holds it high above the head and slowly goes on tilting it to one side. In the process the contents begin to fall on the floor and the other woman holding a similar winnowing fan goes on fanning the contents. This process helps to blow off the hay-dust from the grains

the year 1954-55. The quantities of the produce secured per *bigha* has been shown in seers:—

Crop	Type of land		
	Barani Awal	Barani Doom	Barani Soem
1	2	3	4
Kharif—			
Paddy	50	40	30
Maize	80	65	40
Koda	35	30	20
Bathu (Seul)	45	35	25
Mash	30	25	15
Kulath	20	18	10
Rong	..	20	..
Moth	23	20	15
Potatoes	450	350	300
Moong	23	20	..
Vegetables	180	135	90
Tobacco	90	60	45
Sesamum	20	15	10
Phullan	30	20	15
Bhares	35	25	..
Chinai	35	30	20
Red Chille	90	60	..
Kangni (Koni)	35	30	20
Bajra (Millets)	70	..	..
Rabi—			
Wheat	50	40	25
Barley	80	50	35
Lentils	20	15	10
Grains	60	..	30
Garlic	25	20	10
Tobacco	85	50	..
Potatoes	..	325	..
Red Chillies	75	..	..
Vegetables	150	100	..

Agricultural Calendar

Local Months	English Months	Operations
Poh-Magh	January	Being snow time, fields are left unattended.
Magh-Phalgun	February	Do.
Phalgun-Chaitra	March	Retaining walls are repaired and terraces set in order.
Chaitra-Baisakha	April	Local fertilizers are spread. Ploughings are given to the soil. Levelling up operations are undertaken to make the soil ready for sowing; Tobacco nursery is grown.
Baisakha-Jaishta	May	It is a sowing month. Maize, koda, kangni are sown. In the later part of the month, last ploughing is also given. Besides, Rong (Dolichos Sinenus), Gandoli (a local vegetable), pumpkin, cucumber and chillies are also grown.
Jaishtha-Ashadh	June	In the early part of the month, paddy, chinai, mash, kulath, phullan and bhares are sown; wheat is reaped, hoeing is also done.
Ashadh-Sharawan	July	Earthing is done, weeds like *Baray* and *Perpla* are removed.
Sharawan-Bhadon	August	The operations begun in July are carried forward to this month. Transplanting of plants in respect of tobacco crop is done.
Bhadon-Aswaj	September	It is the harvesting month. Maize, chinai, paddy, kangni and rong crops are harvested. Soil is prepared and one ploughing given. Wheat and barley is sown.
Aswaj-Kartik	October	In the early part paddy, phullan, koda, kuladu and rong are also harvested. Wheat, barley and other Rabi crops are sown. Lentils is sown.
Kartik-Maghar	November	Ploughing and manuring to support the Rabi crops take place in this month.
Maghar-Poh	December	Being snow time, fields are left unattended.

NOTE—Grass or *dholu* as it is called is cut in the month of November. To be stored for the winter season, *baiths* in the form of garlands are prepared for it and served to the cattle who remain indoors during this season.

Plant Diseases and Pests

As elsewhere crops in Chitrari village are also not immune from the menace of plant diseases and pests. The following diseases are common.

Root Borer—It attacks the apple trees and soon the branches become leafless and these are reduced to bare skeleton.

Appilacina betel—Mostly the green vegetables and in particular tomatoes and potatoes are susceptible to this disease. The incidence of the disease cannot be considered too great as these are not much grown in the village.

Sanjoscale—Apple trees are usually the victims of this disease but the incidence is rather on a modest scale.

Loose Smut, Black Smut and Yellow Smut—The crops of wheat and maize are afflicted by these diseases. As an indication of the disease, the crops get more and more yellow at the farms located at heights which are correspondingly more and more high. As a result the wheat crop is completely destroyed. The indigenous names of the disease are *kanunda* or *kalyn*. AGN is being distributed by the Gram Sewak to check the spread of this disease.

Dry Rot—It is a local disease which affects apple trees and the crops of *kangni*.

Blight—This disease affects the crop of potatoes and sometimes the plants of tomatoes also get affected.

Of late, people have come across one particular disease according to which, on ripening the fruit begin to fall without no apparent cause. This disease has not been named so far.

Toka—Is a worm which is playing havoc with the crops of maize, potatoes and capsicum. More or less, every crop is the victim of this worm.

Sada—One of the local diseases *sada* is causing much anxiety among the villagers. It affects the cucumber plants which begin to rot. To check the disease from further spreading, meat water is thrown by the people over the creepers.

In the case of blight, ashes are thrown over the crop which produces instantaneous results. B.H.C. and Gommaxin are being distributed by the Block authorities to check the spread of the disease. In the case of disease caused by *toka* worms, B.H.C. of 15 to 20 per cent strength is distributed. An indigenous treatment has been invented to kill the worm. On location it is wrapped in cloth and cut with the teeth. It is more a superstitious than a scientific treatment to kill the worm.

Livestock

The oxen are kept for ploughing the fields. Cows are reared more for the purpose of cowdung and milk and she-goats for milk and wool, whereas he-goats and rams are utilized for meat. Sheep are reared to obtain wool. Poultry farming has not yet caught their fancy although to take the eggs is no longer considered a taboo as it once used to be.

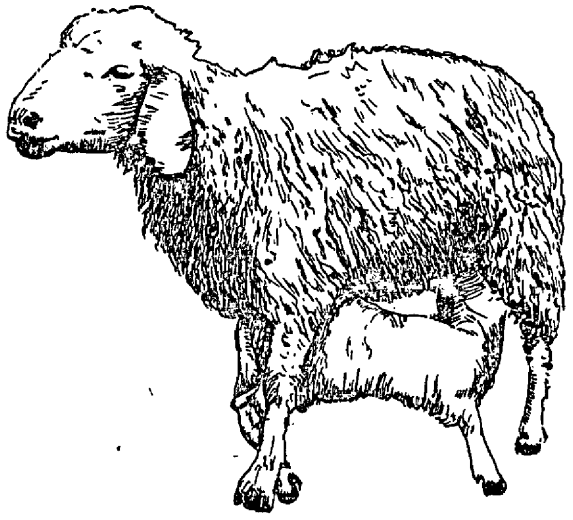
On the whole the quality of the breed of all the animals is very poor and small in size and no efforts towards improvement appeared to have been made in this direction. No artificial insemination centre exists in the village. The main and the only item of fodder is dry grass. The poor conditions of the cattle and non-availability of fodder and growing facilities have resulted in extremely low quantity of yield i.e., from 4 to 8 *chhataks* daily. Milk, therefore, does not form part of their daily diet and is practically non-existent. Even for the purpose of tea, powder milk is to be used. But during the rainy season the Gujjars (a nomadic tribe dealing with milk and its products) come in the nearby areas and settle on the *dhars* and from there the milk can however, be purchased.



An idea about the cattle possessed by the villagers, i.e., from tables prepared from the figures collected on the occasion of cattle census undertaken on *rabi*, 1960.

1.	Oxen	155
2.	Cows—	
	Milch cows	27
	Dry cows	126
	Chohan	32
3.	Calf (he)	20
4.	Calf (she)	48
5.	Sheep	123
6.	Goats	36

NOTE—*Chohan* is a type of cow which is 3 to 4 years old but has not yet started giving the milk.



A sheep with lamb

Although the area adjoining Chitrari and Brahmaur side is popular for its sheep wealth. In Chitrari, these are relatively fewer.

The livestock kept by the Chitrari farmer consists of cattle, sheep and goats and a very few have started keeping poultry. No buffalo is kept by the villagers of Chitrari; one does find a few heads in the adjoining villages. In cattle there is only one non-descript *pahari* breed and 'Himalayan Goats' and Gaddi sheep are to be found among the sheep and goats. The livestock is housed in the ground floor of the same house where the farmer lives. The livestock is fed with green wild grass in so-called pastures during the rainy season and the same grass when dried naturally is stocked for winter. Also *kukriala* is fed in winter when other fodder is scarce. The sheep and goats are fed during winter on *ban* leaves, these trees are found commonly all around the village. No concentrates, howsoever are fed to the livestock and the fodder also is insufficient in quantity, as there is overstocking of the livestock. The average milk yield of cows is very low reaching about 200 gms. and the highest being 450 gms. In goats the average milk yield come about 50 to 60 gms. the highest being 100 gms. (This is based on a note from the Veterinary Assistant Surgeon, Chamba).

Veterinary Dispensary

The principal diseases from which the cattle suffer are rinderpest and foot and mouth diseases. No veterinary facilities were available until recently on the spot. But now a dispensary is functioning in the village which was established on 16th November, 1962, and started working on the 24th November, 1962. The institute is being run by the Compounder-in-Charge. The needs are catered to within a radius of five miles. The other diseases are:—

1. Indigestion (Digestive) and others.
2. Non-contagious diseases. Treatment—stomach powder.
3. Debility is caused due to the shortage of calcium.
4. Colic (Pet-ki-Dard). Treatment—Carminative mixture.

The people do not follow the practice of domesticating wild animals or birds. Rats, sparrows, gunter and jackals are menace to the crops. At the time of ripening of the crops, round-the-clock vigilance has to be maintained against these animals. To avoid the rat menace zinc-phosphide has been distributed among the people by Gram Sewaks. People are not much eager about the use of pesticides as their way of living is governed by traditional modes of thinking. Mules and donkeys are conspicuously absent.

Cropping Pattern

An idea about the type of crops grown in different types of land for different years can be had from the *jinswar* statement.

Cropping Pattern (in acres) for the years 1955—61

Name of Crop	Type of land	1955	1956	1957	1958	1959	1960	1961
KHARIF								
Maize	Barani Awal	49	49	46	49	42	42	..
Kodra		..	6	7	8	9	8	—
Chinai	Barani Awal	24	21	24	20	12	13	..
Phullan	Do.	6	2	2	4	..	1	..
Bhares		..	2	1	1	..	..	..
Seul		..	1	1	..	..	..	..
Koni		..	..	1	..	..	..	..
Kangni		..	1	..	..	..	..	..
Mash	Barani Awal	16	12	14	15	30	30	..

Cropping Pattern (in acres) for the years 1955—61—contd.

Name of Crop	Type of Land	1955	1956	1957	1958	1959	1960	1961
KHARIF—*contd.*								
Moong		..	1	..	..	..	..	..
Chillies		..	1	1	1	1	1	..
Tobacco		..	1	1	1	..	..	..
Rong		..	..	..	..	1	1	..
Maize	Barani Doem	26	25	22	25	11	11	..
Kodra	Do.	..	5	6	7	2	2	..
Chinai	Do.	16	..	1	2	10	10	..
Phullan	Do.	2	..	..	..	1	1	..
Mash	Do.	12	11	12	15	17	16	..
Maize	Banjar Kadim	..	..	..	..	1	1	..
RABI								
Wheat	Barani	40	22	19	25	28	20	21
Barley	Do.	20	11	8	14	12	10	11
Mustard	Do.	1	..	1	1	..	2	..
Wheat	Barani Doem	15	..	7	6	9	11	10
Paddy	Do.	11	..	..	..	..	..	..
Barley	Do.	..	..	..	2	..	8	9

Data showing the average price of land during the last five years (in bighas) has been collected from the village note-books.

Panch-Sala

Year	Name of transfer	Type of transfer	Area sold	Amount
1956	..	..	..	..
1957	5	Sale	3 bigha, 8 biswas	400
1958	7	Sale	0 bigha, 5 biswas	50
1959	..	..	..	..
1960	..	..	..	..
Total	..	..	3 bigha, 13 biswas	450

Average price per bigha—Rs. 123·20

Households owning or possessing land

Community	Nature of interest on land	No. of households and extent of land: No land	5 cents & below	5—10 cents	10—20 cents	21—50 cents	50 cents to one acre	1 to 2·4 acres	2·5 to 4·9 acres	5 to 10 acres	10 acres and above
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12
Brahmins	Ownership	6	..	..	7	5	12	13	6	4	..
Rajput	Do.	..	..	..	..	1	..	2	3	..	..
Khatri	Do.	2	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..
Badhi	Do.	1	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..
Arya	Do.	..	..	..	1	..	..	..	..	..	..
Bainsi	Do.	..	..	..	..	1	..	6	1	..	..
	Land held from private persons—No. of households caste-wise										
Brahmins		..	..	..	2	3	4	9	3	1	..
Rajput		..	..	..	..	..	..	2	..	..	..
Khatri		..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..
Badhi		..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..	..
Arya		..	..	..	..	..	1	..	1	..	..
Bainsi		..	..	1	..	1	1	..	1	..	..

by a margin of 6 and in the latter group the number is even. They constitute 19.8 per cent of the total population.

The old persons in the age-group 60 and over number 14 (8 males and 6 females). In this age-group also, the number of males excel the females by a margin of 2. They constitute 3.5 per cent of the total population.

Trends of Changes in Family Structure

In the absence of comparative data on the subject, we cannot draw inferences in regard to the changes in the family structure. The people have, however, affirmed that the institution of joint family has existed all through the ages. The idea about the size and composition of the households would well be illustrated by the table.

Total No. of Thouseholds	Single Member			2—3 Members			4—6 Members			7—9 Members			10 Members & above		
	House-hold	M	F	House-hold	M	F	House-hold	M	F	House-hold	M	F	House-hold	M	F
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16
80	5	4	1	22	30	29	35	83	96	13	56	47	5	31	27

There are 5 single member households which constitutes 6.25 per cent of the total and only goes to show that people are contented to lead a solitary life and do not expect others to share their family life with them. They are either unmarried or widowed persons. The households having 2-3 members may be described as simple families consisting of husband, wife and at the most one child. More or less the families having 4—6 members can also be termed as simple ones. Together these categories constitute 71.25 per cent of the total and forms a significant proportion. The structure of the economy has influenced the shape of social institutions and the sway which the joint family had at one time loosened its grip on the people's mode of thinking.

The households having 7—9 members may be described as intermediate families consisting of husband, wife, unmarried brothers and sisters and of the parents. They constitute 16.1 per cent of the total. Lastly the joint families consisting of more than one married couple are only 5 which constitutes a percentage of 6.25. Thus only a small number of households prefer to live in joint families which are well-knit units wherein every member has his assigned task. Both men and women enjoy equal social status with the difference that only the men-folk have a right to the share of property.

Birth and Death Statistics

It is one of the functions of the Gram Panchayats to record the births and deaths taking place within the jurisdiction of its circle. The practice was started in April, 1959, and only from that date onwards, the statistics relating to births and deaths are available. The figures supplied by the Panchayat are—

Year	Birth			Death		
	Male	Female	Total	Male	Female	Total
1959 .	4	5	9	2	2	4
1960 .	4	10	14	6	7	13
1961 .	7	6	13	6	3	9
1962 .	5	4	9	1	4	5
Total .	20	25	45	15	16	31

During this period the number of births have far excelled the number of deaths which shows that the upward trend of the population has continued all through the years. 25 girls have born during the period against the figure of 16 which have died during the corresponding period. It shows that female population is on the ascendancy relative to their male counterparts. The increase in the male population is no less significant as 20 births have taken place against the figure of 15 deaths.

The village community is a composite organisation, sub-divided into different sections represented by different castes. Each caste forms a unit by itself and has had its own set of conventions to guide their mutual relationships. But that does not distract from the closely-knit phenomenon of village community as a whole and one finds the different castes cooperating and collaborating between themselves on such occasions as fairs and festivals. In marriage and mourning the entire community joins. Disputes arise occasionally and are resolved by the intervention of elders. Shiv-Shakti fair is not only an important event of the village but the whole region awaits the day with great

eagerness. The inter-hamlet cooperation can be witnessed on this occasion in its best form. Apart from keeping their keeness and interest social units contribute their mite to make the event a successful venture.

Inheritance—Not even a single household can be said to know exactly that there have occurred changes in the Hindu Adoption Act and Hindu Succession Act. More than ninety per cent of the people are against inheritance of property by daughters equally with sons.

Sons whether by a wife married for the first time or by a widow or divorced one married again succeed to the property but illegitimate sons do not claim a share unless they are adopted in defiant of legitimate sons or heirs. The eldest son gets an extra share called *jaithund*, but he has to pay a proportionately larger share of any debts. Among the sons the property is otherwise divided equally.

Chaukandu—There is the custom whereby a *chaukandu* born at any time after his father's death succeeds to his property provided that the widow has continued to live in his house and has worn a red *dori* in the name of his *chula* or *darat*. Cases have been occurred in which the widow has retained her late husband's property without complying with the above conditions, though they consider her rights despicable in that event.

Leisure and Recreation

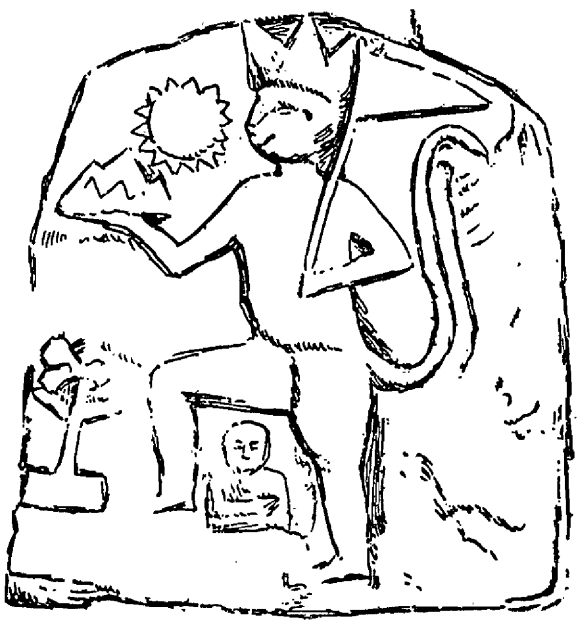
Gaddis have their own distinctive cultural and independent ways of amusement. They live in the midst of nature, cut off from the currents of sophistication and spend a part of their life in travelling through the valley daily and high-mountain passes over the years. These have left an abiding effect on all the facets of their life, social, religious and no less economic. Since times immemorial, fairs and festivals— *jatra* as these are called popularly, have been the converging points of their cultural philosophy. The Gaddis lit up with smiles at the very thought of this word and are swept off their feet and placed in a world of their own creation. These festivals are interspersed all through the year. Folk-songs which echo the depth of their aspirations; reflecting their varied moods are sung on all occasions, in the fields, on the road-sides, on the occasions of births and marriages and also in the homes. Away in the pastures it is common to see a Gaddi youngster playing on his flute, producing the sweet and melodious tune. In winter they have sufficient leisure time and some of them can be seen very often clustering around the kitchen hearth playing a game of cards, *chhikdi* and *chopar*. Sometimes the people assemble in the spacious courtyard of the temple and recite *bhajans* in chorus. A few of them who have grown grey may spend their time in spinning wool with the help of *takli*. Children play the games of *kabaddi*, *gulidanda* and hide and seek. The game of pebbles also appears to have caught their fancy although it is a rare sight to come across. The games played in the local school are volley-ball, *kabaddi* and ring. Women do not seem to be fond of any games as none was mentioned in spite of persistent inquiries. Their only recreation consists of singing the folk-songs and dressing themselves gaudily on fairs and festivals.

Of late Panchayat has also realised the importance of recreational aspect of their activities. The musical instruments like *dholki*, *chimta* and harmonium have been provided for the use of the people. These are utilized mostly on marriages and other happy occasions. With a view to encourage the modern games, badminton-rackets have also been provided.

Twice or thrice a year, especially at fairs and festivals, educative documentaries are exhibited in the village by the Public Relations Department. A cinema show at Chamba is a must for them whenever they go there.

Religion and Temples

The whole of the village population professes Hinduism. But some of the features



Relief work on stone—Hanuman

of the Gaddis with regard to religion present an interesting study. Gaddis are by preference Shaivas. Even though the image in the local Shakti temple is of Devi but essentially this is a branch of Shaivism. The Devi is known as Shiv-Shakti, that is, the power of Lord Shiv. They also worship some lesser gods such as Sidh, Nagh, and Kailing which too are, in a way, branch of Shaivism.



Fountain slab

Shrine Paroli-Wali-Devi

The very entrance to the village through a *parol* or gate indicates the religious importance of the village. *Parol,* located on a little elevated place is open on both the sides and resembles a shrine. This shrine houses an image of Paroli-Wali-Devi and some crude stone carvings representing some other deities which the villagers could not describe. This shrine is quite an old monument and it could not be ascertained as to when and by whom it was built. There is no particular priest appointed to look after it. However, people have great faith



Fountain Slab

in the Devi and very often make a little offering of a coin or so while passing through it. It is a common practice to sacrifice a lamb or goat at the shrine by way of *sukhna,* an offering for the fulfilment of a desire. Nearabout the temple, some layers of the soil are black in colour. Also some portion of the rocky space is red. These two phenomena are explained away with the help of a legend which is quite current in the region.

In the days of yore, seven sisters lived together and led quite an harmonious life. They were Tul, Kangri-Wali-Devi, Shakti-Devi, Paroli-Wali-Devi, Mahalay-Wali-Devi, Jawala-Mukhi and Dhanu-Ghodi. A day came when they quarrelled amongst themselves and decided to get separated from each other. They had a lot of gold and jewellery which could only be divided equally with the help of balance. It was agreed to send Paroli-Wali-Devi which happened to be the youngest, somewhere to arrange for the



Fountain slab

balance. She went to a nearby village Meri and approached an old lady where she asked her to spare her balance for sometime. The old woman was quite shrewed and at once recognised that the one who was asking for balance was some deity. She got her absorbed in conversation and thus she was delayed. In the meantime, in her absence the remaining six sisters divided the wealth and left nothing to her share. When Paroli-Wali-Devi returned she was much disappointed and wept bitterly. The soil on which her tears fell became pitch dark in a while. The little clusters of the soil are called Suniya-Mukhi. Again the rocky space against which she stumbled became red as it is believed the space bears the imprints of her blood which oozed out from the injury caused to her.

The temple of Shakti Devi is situated in the heart of the village. Elaborate studies about its archaeology have already been made from time to time and here it would be just sufficient to reproduce certain relevant extracts from Chamba Gazetteer.

"Chitrari is situated 24 miles from Chamba (32° 27′ North and 76° 24 E) on the way to Brahmaur, and is a *tirtha* or place of pilgrimage. The only object of worship is an ancient temple, containing a brass image of Shakti-Devi or Kali, which, as the inscription shows, was erected by Raja Meru Varman (A.D. 700). The workman named Gugga, who erected the temples at Brahmaur, is said to have first built a house at Kothi Ranhu for the local Rana and had his right hand cut off to prevent from erecting as fine a residence for any one else. The hand is believed to have been miraculously restored by the Goddess Shakti when he was called upon to build her temple at Chitrari. Another tradition exists to the effect that Gugga was accidentally killed by a fall from the roof of the temple porch, after having all but completed his work.

The temple of Shakti Devi at Chitrari which, as we know, belongs to the same period as that of Lakshana, is a good specimen of the hill shrine described above. The outer doorway, however, is evidently a latter addition, and the coarse frescoes on the wall of the cella are of quite recent date. The ornamentation of the inner doorway is very similar to that of the Lakshana temple. Here also we find over the entrance, a row of flying figures four on each side—the two in the centre carrying a crown whereas the remaining six are accompanied by female figures each seated on the hip of its companion. Beneath these there is a row of thirteen cross-legged figures of which nine represent the *nava-grahas* i.e., the Sun, the Moon, the five planets—Mars, Mercury, Jupiter, Venus and Saturn—the eclipse—*dewan* Rahu and the comet Ketu. Rahu is represented by a demon's head without a body, in agreement with the myth told in the *puranas*. It is said that Rahu stealthily partook of the nectar (Amrita) produced by the churning of the ocean, but was betrayed by the Sun and the Moon, who had noticed the theft. He was beheaded by Vishnu, but the head had become immortal by the use of the nectar. Since then the Rahu had persecuted the Sun and the Moon and causes them to eclipse. The four remaining figures at the two ends possibly represent the Guardians of the Four Regions (Loka Palas).

Along the door-junks we find a double row of standing figures on each side of the entrance. Those of the two outer rows, alternate with crouching animal-headed figures which act as Atlantes, and presumably are meant either for *rakshashas* or for the *ganas* of Shiva. Among the standing figures we notice to the sight the six-faced Karttikeya with his peacock and Indra the rain-god holding a thunderbolt (vajra) and accompanied by his vehicle the elephant (Airavata) and to the left the four-armed

Brahma, carrying a rosary and a water-pot and accompanied by a pair of *geeta*. The inner rows consist each of four figures. On the left side we recognise Vishnu three-faced, the side faces being a lion's and a boar's, and Durga slaying the buffalo-demon. The two lowermost figures are again Ganga and Yamuna, the personifications of the sacred rivers of India. In the upper corners of the door-way we notice the same winged dragons as we found on the Lakshana temple.

The wooden pillars with their pot and foliage capitals, supporting elaborately carved bracket—capitals in which couchant bulls and other animals have been introduced, deserve special notice."

There are a number of silver ornaments in the temple with which the Goddess is adorned on the festive occasion. The number of these ornaments with the description of their weight can be had from this list—

List of ornaments (silver) in the Shiv-Shakti Temple

Serial No.	Ornament	Weight No.	Tolas	Mashas	Rati
1	Big Chattar (Canopy)	1	33	0	0
2	Do.	1	6	0	0
3	Do.	1	12	6	0
4	Do.	1	13	6	0
5	Do.	1	12	3	0
6	Small Chattar (Canopy)	4	9	3	0
7	Big Necklace with stones and enamelling	1	46	0	0
8	Big Salieha with glasses	1	15	0	0
9	Big Mukat (head-dress) with Tika	1	11	0	0
10	Small Salieha with glasses	1	5	8	0
11	Dodmala with thread, stones and enamelling	1	16	0	0
12	Dodmala with threads	1	13	6	0
13	Chokli with threads	1	7	4	0
14	Zhanzra with threads	2	13	10	4
15	Patki necklace with thread	1	7	0	0
16	Nazziri	1	5	0	0
17	Man Tika with thread & Saliza	1	4	5	0
18	Dalku-Janku with brass thread (Ears)	1	7	4	0
19	Attardan	1	3	7	0
20	Rakhni	1	2	0	0
21	Guthlamaya glasses (thumb)	1	2	2	0
22	Chuday (arm)	4	21	9	0
23	Gojru Do.	4	14	3	0
24	Mukkat (head-dress) with thread	1	3	9	0
25*a*	Kangnu (broken)	1	4	7	4
b	Kangnu (complete)	1			
26	Katori (cup)	4	5	6	0
27	Danda-Mutha	1	12	5	4
28	Danda Chonri	1	6	2	4
29	Danda with wood	1	30	6	0
30	Asa with wood and Shamloha	1	78	0	0

Charauta Temple

A few minutes walk up the mountain slopes from the main *abadi* is the Charauta temple. The establishment of the temple has an interesting legend behind it and the year about which it was situated is not known to anybody. It is believed that at one time the whole area was under the jurisdiction of the Ranas of Gehra. Rains failed and the conditions of famine became apparent. A Bhoat from Bhotant had come this year and was wandering through the area. He listened to the harrowing tales of the people and promised them rain only if they agreed to give 5 goats by way of sacrifice to the Bhatoad Naga every three years. These five goats were to consist of one black and 4 white. The place of the Bhatoad Naga is a day's journey from the village. The people agreed to this proposal and found to their joys the skies being overcast with thick clouds immediately. Now it has become a practice with them to visit the place of Bhatoad Naga every three years and offer the said five goats. The fund is collected by the people of all the neighbouring villages and a sort of delegation nominated by them to do the job. There in Charauta a stone image of Bhatoad Naga is housed in a small shrine which is all wooden structure. This stone image is flanked by two brass images of attendants. Apart from these three images, five images of Auttars and one wooden image of Hedami Devi is also placed there. *Sangals* or iron chains are also placed in one corner which are used by the *chela* whenever he is possessed by the spirits. The other lesser articles are peacock feathers *hawan-kund*, two flutes. Kall—a two piece musical instrument made of copper—four bells, three conchshells, one Dhamadh—an iron utensil used for performing the *arti* of the deity and one iron *tirsul*. As feasts are generally held by the people in honour of the deity, some utensils are also there among the articles held by the temple institution. There are 25 big bronze plates, three cooking vessels, one *lota* or tumbler, one small plate and one *batloi*.

Jetha or the first Sundays of months Sawan, Katak, Har, Jeth and Baisakh are considered very auspicious and the devotees hold *jagra* on these nights. *Jagra* stands for awakening all through the night and singing the hymns or *bhajans* in praise of the deity. People buy about two seers of grains and either a goat or lamb as a token of the fulfilment of their wish. The barren ladies have a great faith in the act of *jagra* and very often offer goats and sheep as a mark of *sukhma*. The *pujari* or the priest of the temple gives her instructions compliance with

other versions of the legends we are producing here. For those who have read these epics in their original form would get a glimpse of how these have turned out to be different amongst different communities.

Shiva and Gorja were living happily for some time when an idea struck Shiva to go on a long sojourn in the high mountain ranges of Himalayas. But Gorja did not agree to this idea and pursuaded her Lord not to leave her alone. To overcome her obstinacy, Shiva took a handful of ashes and created a legendary-ghost Bhashmi Dant. Also a word was bestowed on him that he would never die except in one condition. Whenever he may place his hand on his head, he would die instantaneously as his wrist carried a ring of that type. Thus Bhashmi Dant became immortal.

In the absence of Shiva, Bhashmi Dant got perverted in his views and wanted to kill Shiva and have Gorja. One day Shiva came to meet his consort but was threatened by Bhashmi Dant. He left for Talundi-da-Mud and hid himself there. In so roaming about a period of twelve years elapsed, a great furor arose among the gods and deities. Shiva's parents took him as died. But gods Brahma and Mahesh knew the truth and one day came to Shiva in his hide-out, Talundi-da-Mud. They calmly planned for future.

Brahma dressed up like Gorja and went to Bhashmi Dant. He agreed first to dance like Shiva. Bhashmi Dant suggested later. Brahma agreed to it. In the course of cohabitation, Brahma got pregnant and was advised by Mahesh to exchange his pregnancy with Anjili. In the course of dancing like Shiva, Bhashmi Dant raised up his hand and put it on his head. The very moment Shiva's word became effective and he died instantaneously. When Shiva went to his house to meet his parents, they were performing the rites of *pinds*. Not to injure the feelings of Shiva they told him that an *arti* or *nawala* was being performed in honour of his home-coming. Thus started the *nawala* from that day onwards. Shiva's *mandal* is sketched on the floor either with wheat or maize flour. It is a square with sides about 24 inches in length. Along with two sides of the square facing each other are placed 32 *pindis*, 16 on each side, which may be of maize or wheat flour. In the centre of the square, a big *pindi* dedicated to Shiva is placed. Now a ring of a twig is formed and five garlands of flowers woven in woollen thread are fastened to it. One of the garlands is relatively a bigger one. The ring is made to suspend just above the *mandal*. Apart from all this a few articles like 8 and half seers of wheat or maize flour and 10 *thimbis* of other grains are set aside and given over to *jogi* or Brahmin if the former is not present on the occasion. The lesser articles which are given to the *jogi* may include sesamum, *kungee*, some rice, blades of *drub*, dry fruit, honey, curd and milk. The whole structure is worshipped all through the night and *ainchalis* sung in praise of Lord Shiva. Four *bandas*—persons who participate prominently in the function sing *cholis*. The occasion is important for other reasons also, as friends and relatives are invited. All of them sing together and make the occasion really a colourful one. The person who has sponsored the *nawala* holds a big feast or *dham* the next day. The big garland which was suspended above the *mandal* all through the function is preserved with great care. It is worshipped on the occasions of births and marriages. At the time of fixing the auspicious date for marriages if the planets and stars do not coincide they may fix the date arbitrarily keeping their faith in *nawala*. On this day as many as three garlands are worshipped.

These are the few lines of *ainchalis* which are commonly sung on *nawalas*—

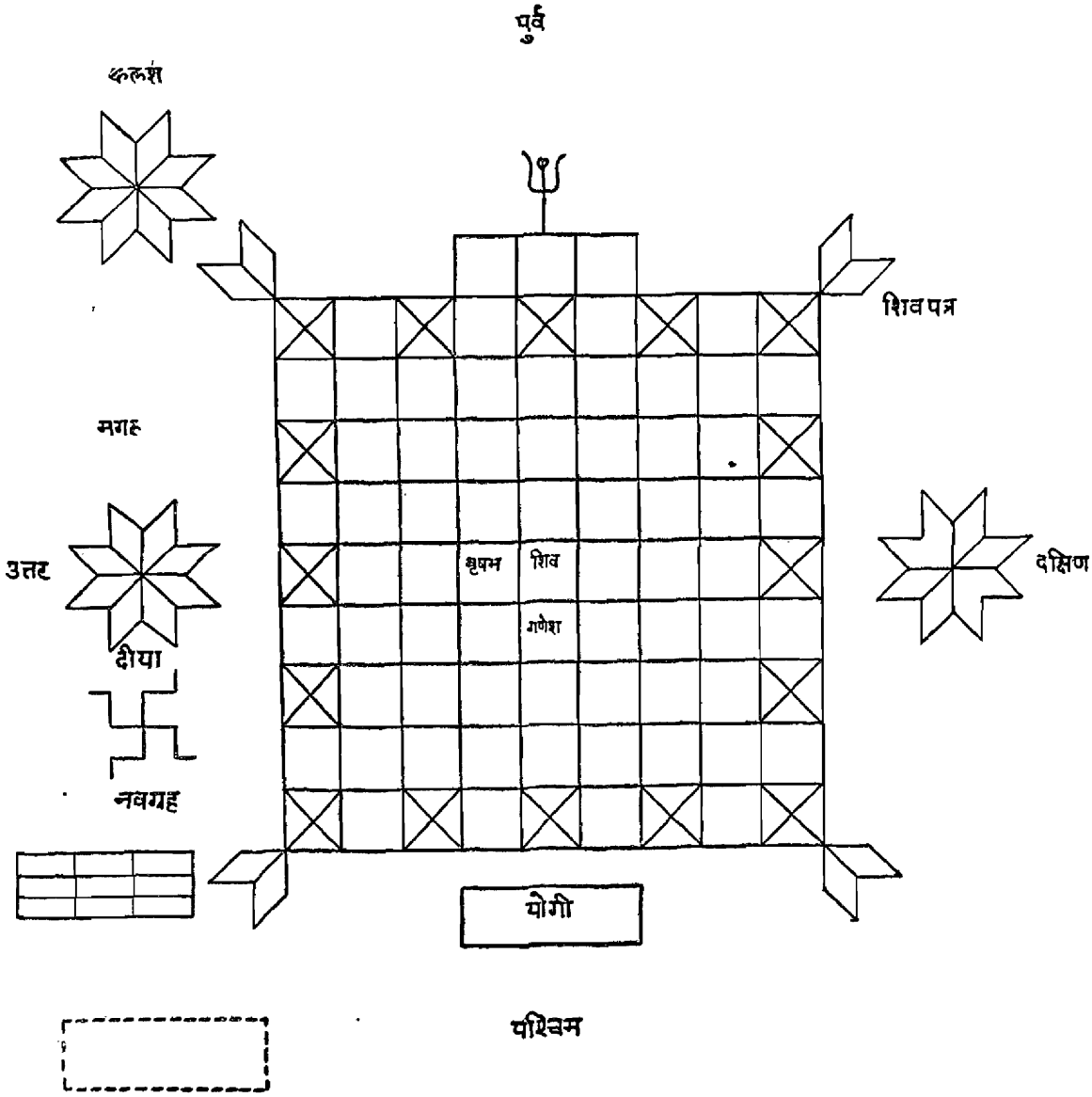
किस मुलख सिद्ध योगी आये
दक्षिण देशे दा सिद्ध योगी आयें
अत पश्चिम देशे दी मालिन आई
आ वि जुगरिया वोह् वो जोगेटुआ
अज सोड पौणे वो रहना
मालिन ने फुल चुगे
सिद्ध योगी माल गुन्दी
आद कदें तेरा मंडल रचाया
वै जी शिवा [illegible]
मीड़े भेडुए तेरा जग वो रचाया
[illegible] वन्दे तेरा घर रचाया
लै जी [illegible]

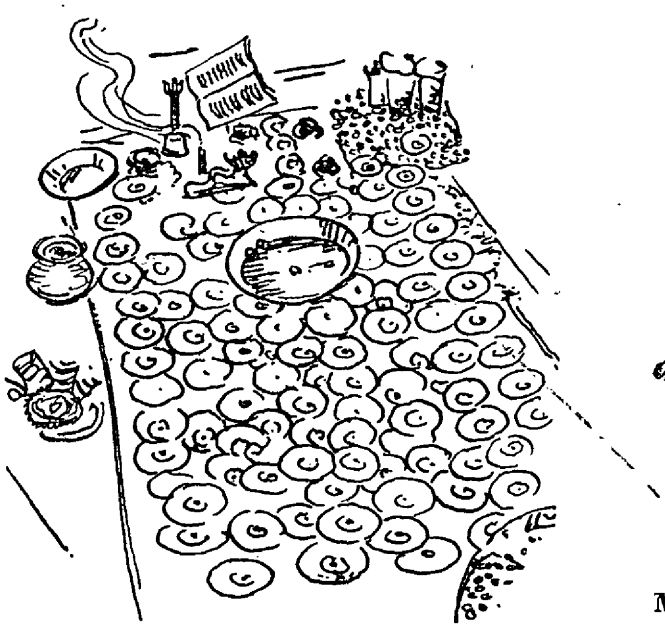
(The *ainchali* is in the form of questions and answers. *Sidh Yogi* stands for Shiva. The singers are inquiring as to the place wherefrom the Lord hath come. He has come from the country of South and the flower selling man from the West. O'Lord Shiva come and be our guest for the night. The maid has picked up the flowers and the *jogi* has woven a beautiful garland. A *mandal* has been sketched in your honour with the help of flour. O'Lord take here your obligation. Everybody has excelled each other to honour you and the *bandas* here showered praises profusely upon you).

Nawala—According to a version *nawala* is said to have been derived from the word *navmala* meaning (new garland). During the performance of *nawala*, Shiva is worshipped at

night. Inside the house a square of rice flour in the centre of the room is prepared and *Shivpindi* is placed on it. Also heaps of *atta* and *dal* denote the Kailash and other like. Then an artistic garland of seasonal flowers is prepared and hung from a hook in the ceiling over the *pindi*. A priest conducts the ceremonies and a person performing the *puja* offers a *sankalap* wherein he mentions the articles to be offered in sacrifice, but in some cases the sacrifice may be confined to the offering of a coconut only. The services of 4 persons called *bandas* are requisitioned, who sing devotional songs in praise of Lord Shiva throughout the night followed by others present there. These songs are called *Shiv Ainchalis*, and describe birth, marriage and other phases in Shiva's life.

A *chela* is also summoned who goes into trance as soon as the sacrifices are offered to Shiva and is said to be possessed of the Lord Himself. He answers questions put to him by the members of the household and their friends present. If the animal sacrifice is offered water is first sprinkled on the animal and if it shivers, the animal is considered to be acceptable to the God, and then beheaded. The *puja* generally finishes by the mid-night and all others excepting the members of the household and their near relations then depart. The household along with the 4 *bandas* keep awake throughout the night (jagaran) and keep on singing hymns of Shiva. Next day a feast is thrown to relatives and friends and the *nawala* comes to an end.







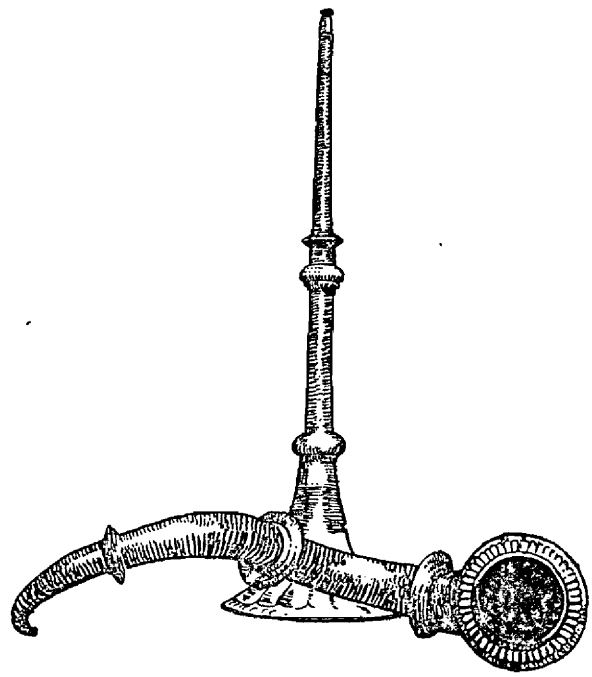
Goat sacrifice

Musical Instruments

The traditional musical instruments are *dhol, dholak, shehnai, narsingha, Bansuri, nigara, jang* and *kal. Dhol* is an ordinary drum and is beaten to the rhythm. *Nigara* is beaten to the rhythm and the accompanying instrument is *narsingha. Dholak* is a variation of *dhol* and is used when *bhajans* are sung. *Jang* is the mouth organ and a very sweet and melodious sound is produced. *Kal* is two piece instrument made of copper. On marriages and other festive occasions they

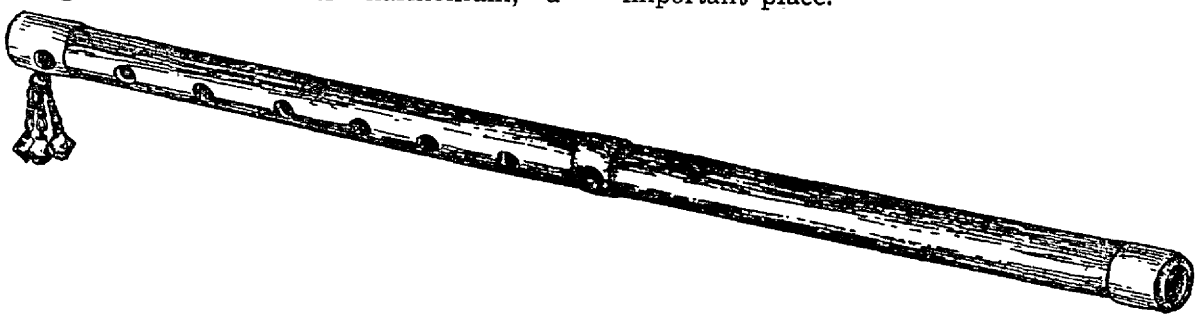


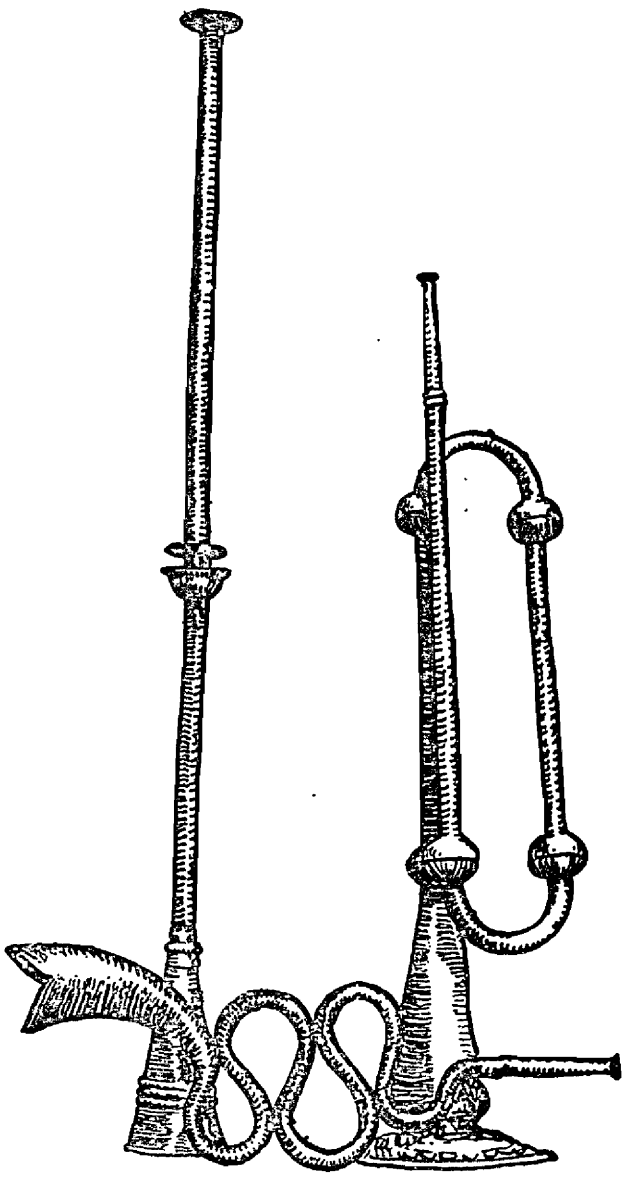
Performing Puja during Nawala

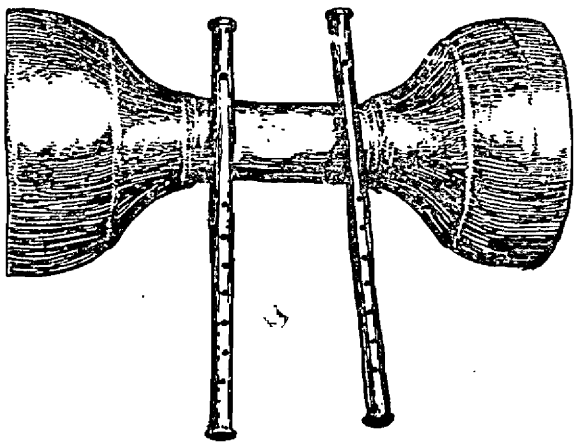


Karnal and Haransingha

play on these instruments quite profusely. Among other instruments harmonium, a pair of *chimtas* and *khartals* occupy an important place.







Some musical instruments

General Superstitions

The months of Chaitra, Pausa and Magha are regarded as unlucky and are called *kale mahine* or black months. The people like to hear the name of Chaitra, first month of the Vikrami year, from the lips of lower castes and the name of Magha is best heard from a class of Brahmins named Bas Bari, who come up during this month from the plains to sing and beg from house to house. If a cow has given birth to a calf in the month of Bhadra, both the cow and its calf must be given away in charity to avert the misfortune. Sundays, Tuesdays and Saturdays are unlucky days for celebrating the marriage. It is a belief among the people that if the marriage is solemnized on Sundays, the couple would never agree with each other. The husband is likely to die soon if marriage has taken place on Tuesday. Lastly they are likely to land in trouble if married on Saturdays.

Dreams

Superstitions are also attached to the dreams and these are interpreted accordingly. If a person dreams in the early morning, it is believed to come true. If in a dream, a dead relative appears and mentions some date on which the dreamer will die, some measures are taken to avert the bad effect of the influence. A *chela* or *bir* is summoned on this date who dance continuously till they become giddy. Others, including the close friends and relatives try in many ways to divert the man's attention till the critical time has passed. The omen is inauspicious if in a dream copper or iron is given to the person dreaming. A dog coming towards the person to bite him is also considered ominous and is called as the effect of some bad *grah*. An elephant in a dream means that god Ganesha is angry and must be appeased usually by way of worship. If a hog appears in the dream, Maha Dev is signified. A snake coming towards the dreamer to bite him is a bad omen. If some one is seen to leave the house, the person dreaming is likely to die. But if an ailing relation is seen dying, he or she is believed to recover soon. Crossing a stream in a dream points to some trouble ahead.

Evil Spirits

The belief in evil spirits exerts a powerful influence on the people's way of thinking. Evil Spirits and fairies are believed to have a special liking for fair-complexioned children and thus a black mark is put on the children's forehead to keep these away and also to ensure protection against the power of evil eye. The underlying idea seems to be that these malign influences affect beauty more readily than ugliness. Charms and *amulets* are in general used to keep away ghosts or *bhuts* and also to ensure safety against the bad effects of evil spirits or evil eye.

Auttars or the spirits of the dead are believed to appear in dreams and warn people that they will carry them off to the next world. An *auttar* is the spirit of a person who has died childless and causes sickness. To propitiate this spirit, the sick person puts on clothes which are specifically made for him with a silver image of the deceased. He then goes over to the stream or spring and worships the idol which is installed there invariably. Images in stone and wood are carved and kept near the springs. These are prepared by the Tarkhans and Lohars. These *auttars* are worshipped on Sankranti by the members of the family. Also on *amawas* and *puranmashi puja* is offered to them. To scare away the ghosts, *chela* or *bir* is called for as he is adept in the technique of summoning the various gods to ward off the evil spirits. On his behalf, the evil spirits are offered with 4 balls of boiled maize flour called *ghungamion*.

But these do not exhaust the list of beliefs. *Batal* is the spirit of the springs, river and wells and *jognis* that of rocks. To ward off these spirits, 3 coloured grains of rice, 5 *rotis*, a loaf, a *diwa* with red wick, 3 pieces of *dhup* and a she-goat are offered and prayers offered. *Changu* is another demon found on walnut and mulberry trees. His worship is done with cocoanut, a *chhuara*, almonds, milk and a *rote* of flour with his effigy and a lamp of flour on it. *Chela* is always summoned for the purpose who performs the rites.

Gunga is another prominent spirit of the region and is believed to affect the cattle with various types of diseases. Till the day of final offering, *tawa* is set aside in its name. Thursday is the day chosen for the purpose when a piece of iron like a miniature bent stick is picked up to symbolise the spirit and taken to the cattle shed. Here sacred fire is lit up in one corner to perform the rites. He-goat is slaughtered and a few drops of blood sprinkled on the piece of iron. Flour cakes are also offered in this way and some eaten by the members of the family. Generally this is repeated every four years.

To the Devis and lesser deities are offered vermilion, *bindi, salu, dora, sura* dna a goat To the *birs* a he-goat, a *chola* or thick woollen coat, a waist band, a white conical cap and five breads are offered. Kailubir, the spirit of abortion, is worshipped only by the women-folk. Kailing is a Nag, and the father of all the Nags. He is worshipped like Shiva in the form of sickle, always carried by a Gaddi while grazing his flocks.

Status of Women

Women occupy a position of no less importance than men both in the domestic as well as in the wider social spheres. They are entitled to all the normal respects and privileges which a woman receives elsewhere. Almost in all the family matters it is she whose voice is the determining factor. As a matter of convention husbands do not by-pass her advice in matrimonial alliances, both of the sons and daughters, and can well illustrate the point of her importance as it is with her consultation that the matter is finally concluded. Leaving aside the domestic sphere, she is a co-worker with the male folks

APPENDIX II

Some Sentences in Gaddi Dialect and Folk Songs.

1. Where are you going?	तु करहा हैं चलूरा या
2. I am going home.	आऊं धरा जो चलू रा हऊं
3. How are you?	दुघा कें हाल हा
4. I am quite well.	मेरा खरा हाल हा
5. Where is your home?	तुंधे घर कठीहिन
6. My home is here.	मेरे घर इठीं हिन
7. What do you do?	तुसे कै कम करनदै हिन
8. I am an agriculturist.	अऊं खेती करनू
9. What does he do?	सो कै कम करन्दा
10. He is an agriculturist.	सो खेती करन्दा
11. I intend going to Delhi.	मेरी मरजी देहली गाहणे री हा
12. How many brothers have you?	तेरे कैत्रैः भाई हिन
13. I have four brothers.	मेरे चौर भाई हिन
14. I am taking my meals.	अऊं अऊं खाया लगूरा हा
15. I am feeling sleepy.	मुंजी निन्द्र लगुरी हा
16. We are hill people.	असे पहाड़ी लोक हिन
17. Snowfall is heavy here.	इन्धी जगा हिऊं मतापैंदा
18. Rainfall is little here.	इठी वर्षा घट पुदी हा
19. We go down.	असे थुन्हु गौधै हिन
20. Go up.	उप्पर गाह
21. What is your name?	तेरा ना कै हा
22. My father has gone with the sheep and goats.	मेरा [illegible]चच घणा हरा गछरा हा ।।

(From "Sunlight and Shadow" Dr. Karan Singh—Asia Publications)

लोक गीत नं० १

तेरा लगदा मंदा ओ गद्दिया

१. तेरा लगदा मंदा वो गद्दिया
तेरा लगदा मंदा जी ओ

२. ए पटवारी खत लिखी नइओं दिन्दा
करनियां सौ सौ छन्दा ओ गद्दिया
तेरा लगदा मंदा जी ओ

३. इकली दुकली मैं पनियेंगी [illegible]
[illegible]
तेरा लगदा मंदा [illegible]

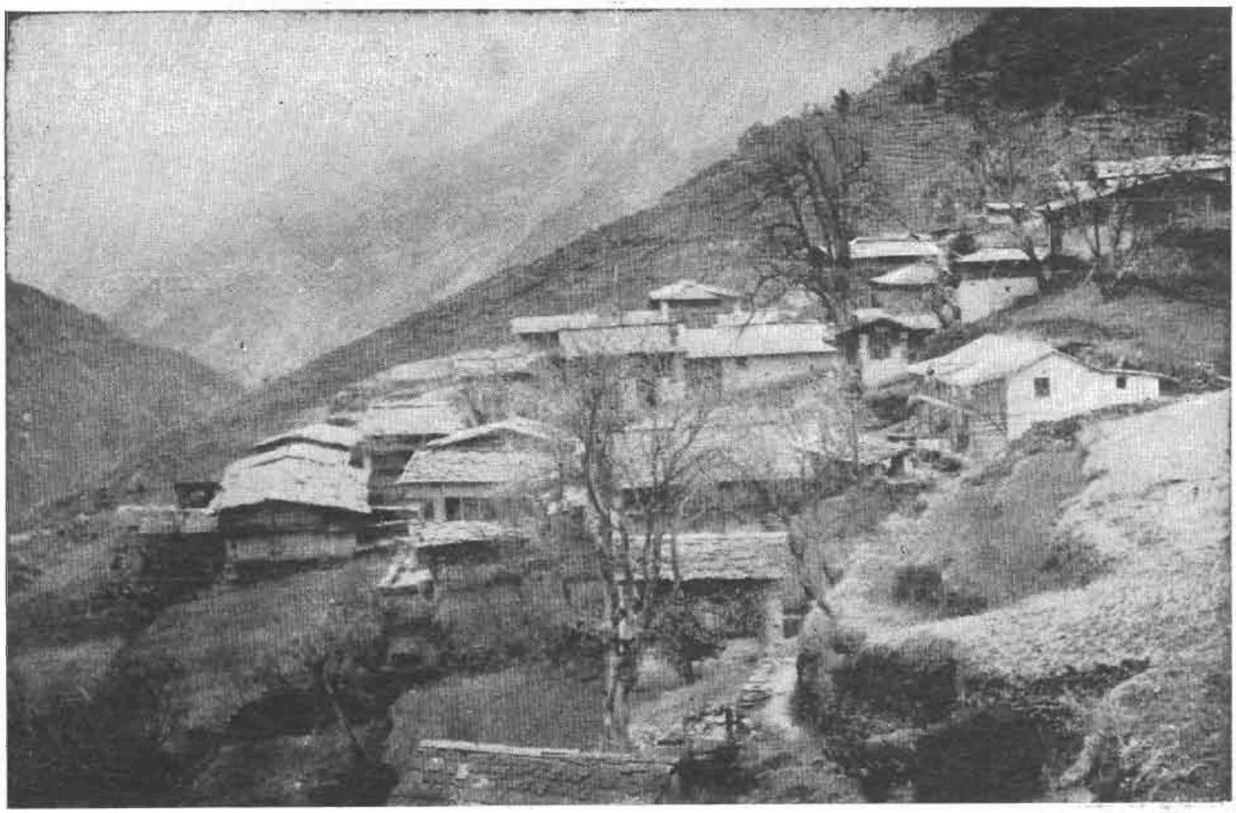
४. नंगे [illegible] मैं पहाड़ चड़ी [illegible]
[illegible]
तेरा लगदा मंदा [illegible] ॥

The love-sick Shepherdess.

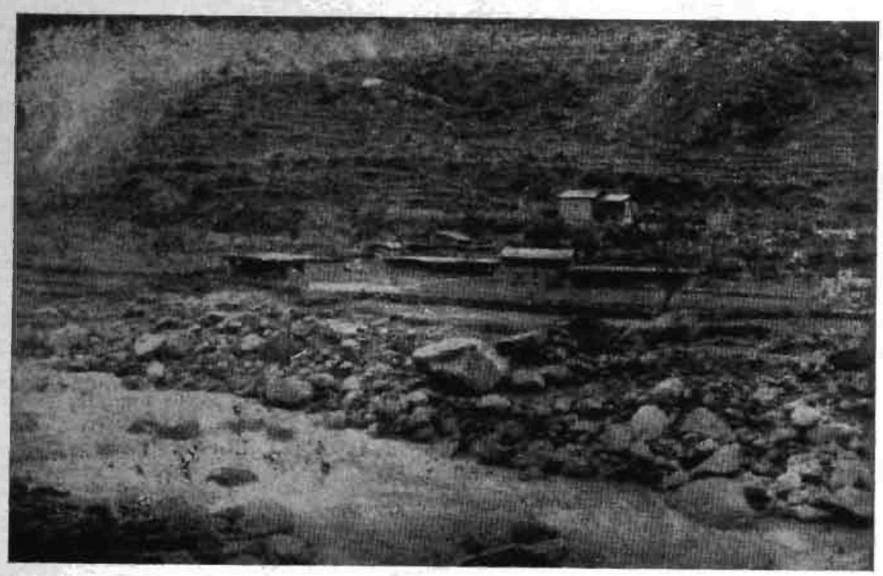
1. I miss you terribly, by Gaddi,
I miss you very very much.
2. This Patwari will not write a letter for me though I beseech him a thousand times.
I miss you very much, my beloved Gaddi.
3. I go alone to the spring
and drink there in seclusion.
and suddenly your memory pierces my heart,
I miss you very much, my beloved Gaddi.
4. With naked feet I climb the hill
hoping to see you return,
but my feet are pierced by the sharp thorns,
and of you there is no sign.
I miss you very much, my beloved Gaddi.



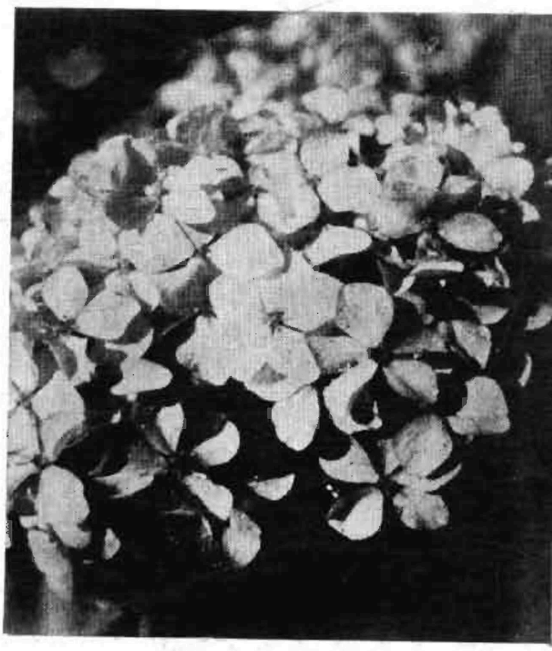
A view of Chitrari



The Village



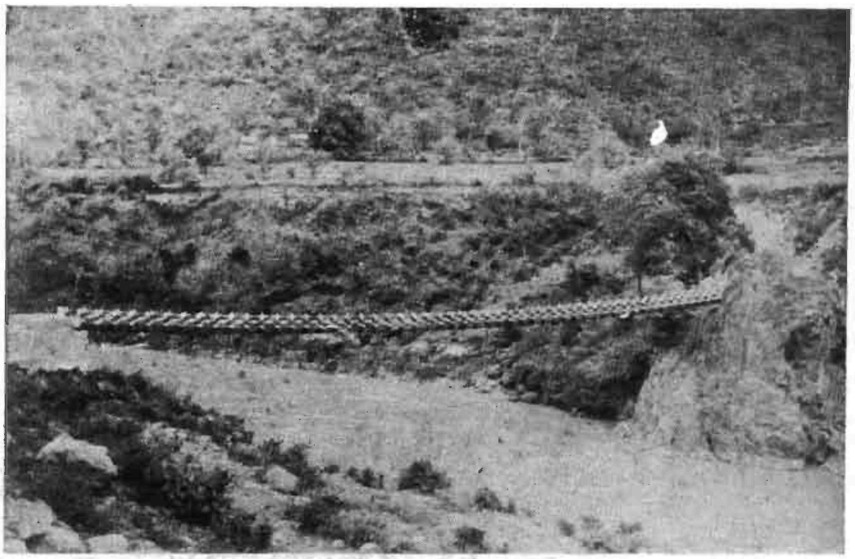
Bakan—A Gujjar village



Apple blossoms



Houses



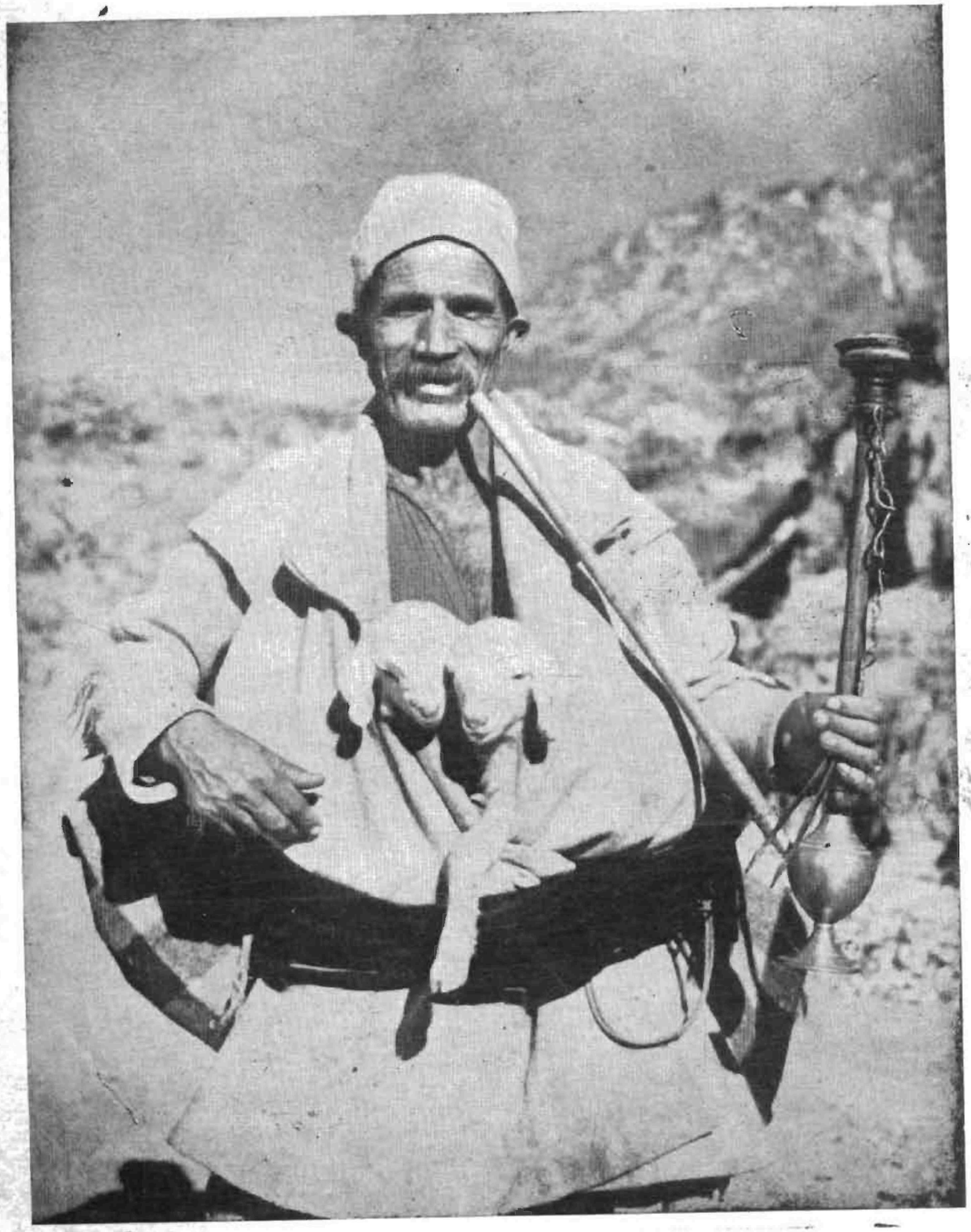
The bridge below Chitrari



Potato Plants



Typical house



A Gaddi



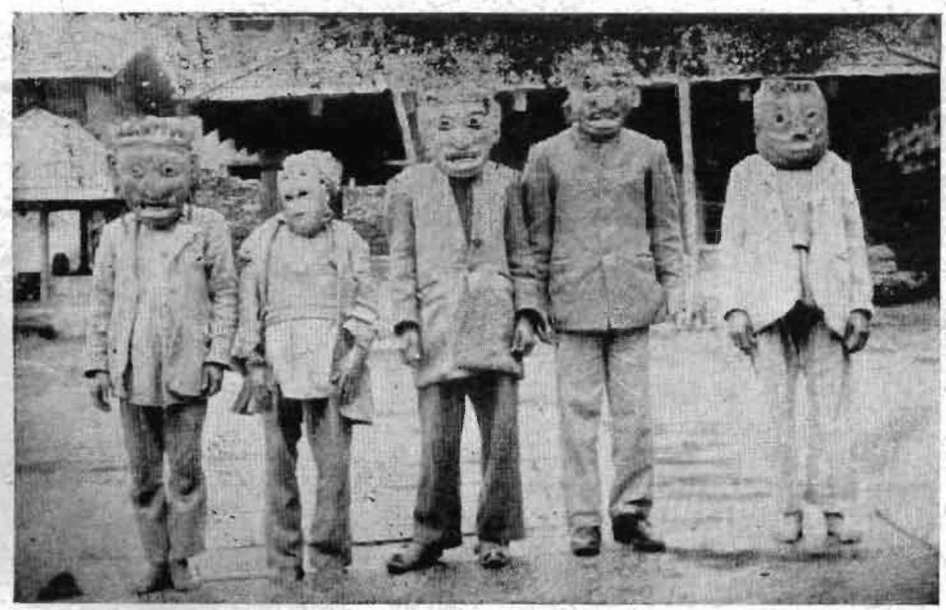
And his consort



Jewellery



Playing on Jung



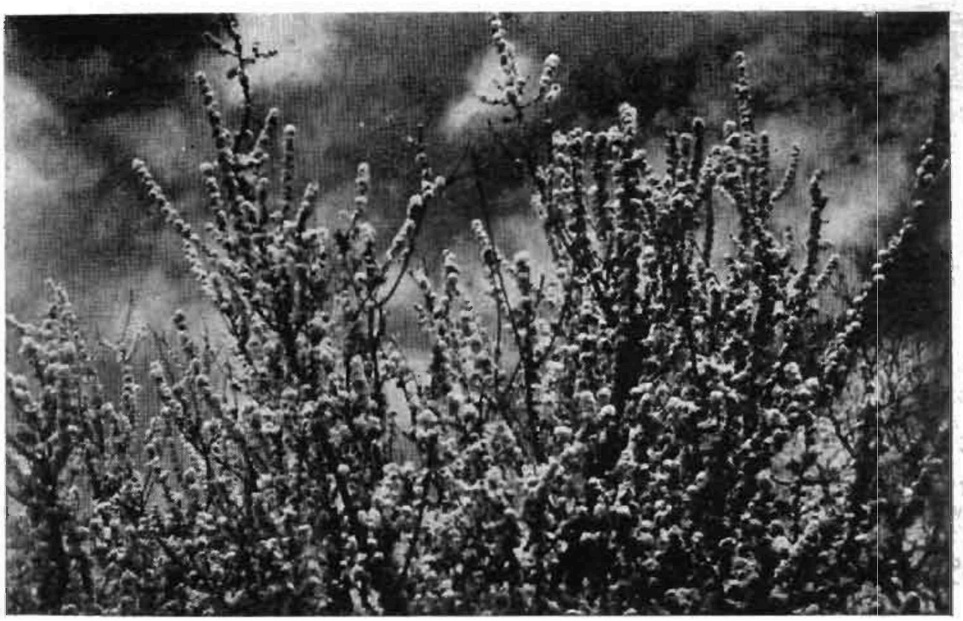
Masks



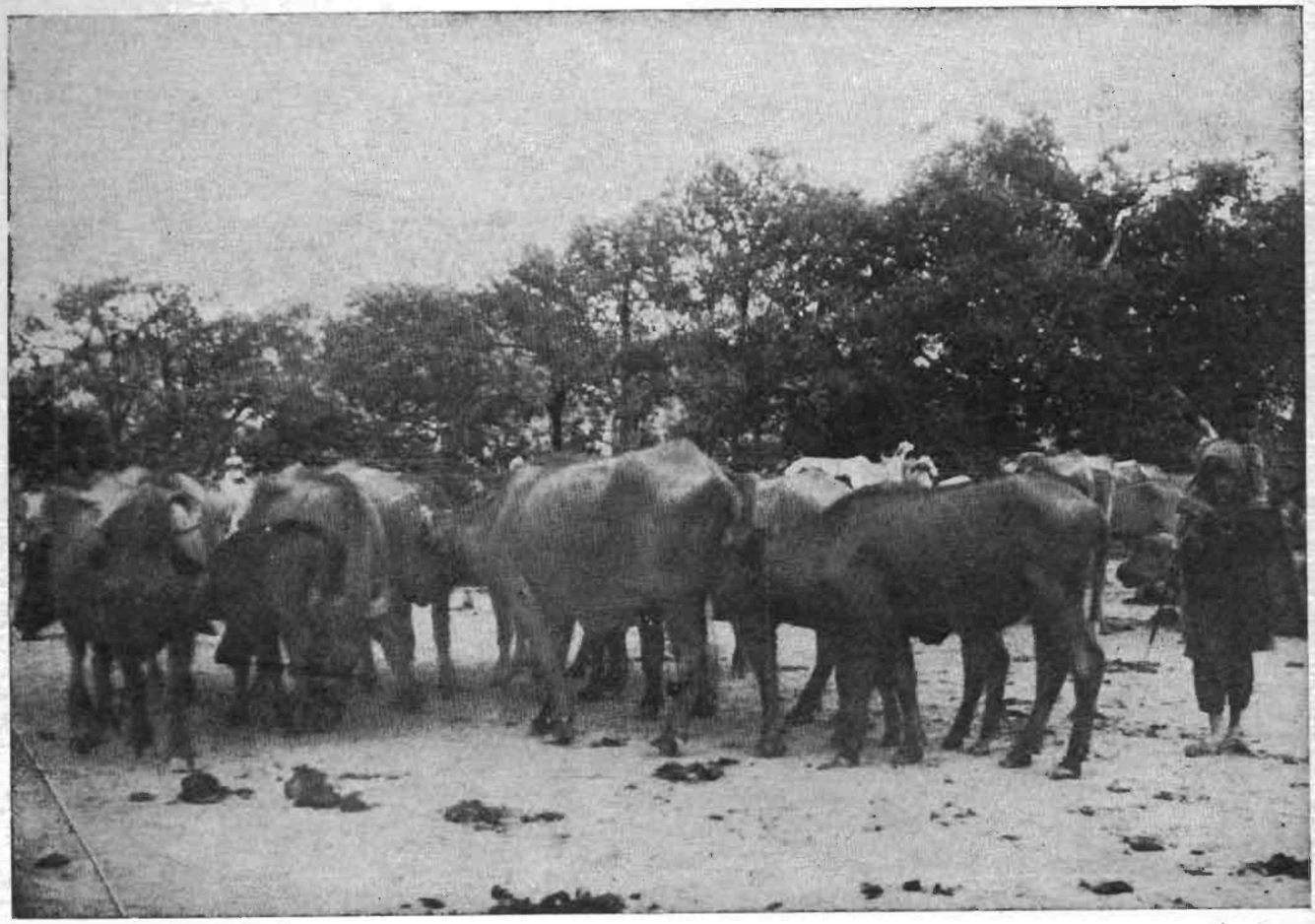
Poola-making



A process in Weaving



Blossoms



Buffaloes



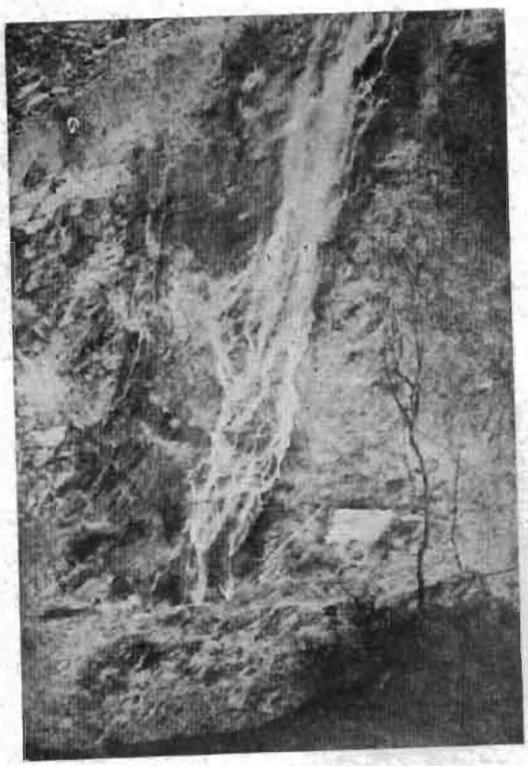
Fountain slabs



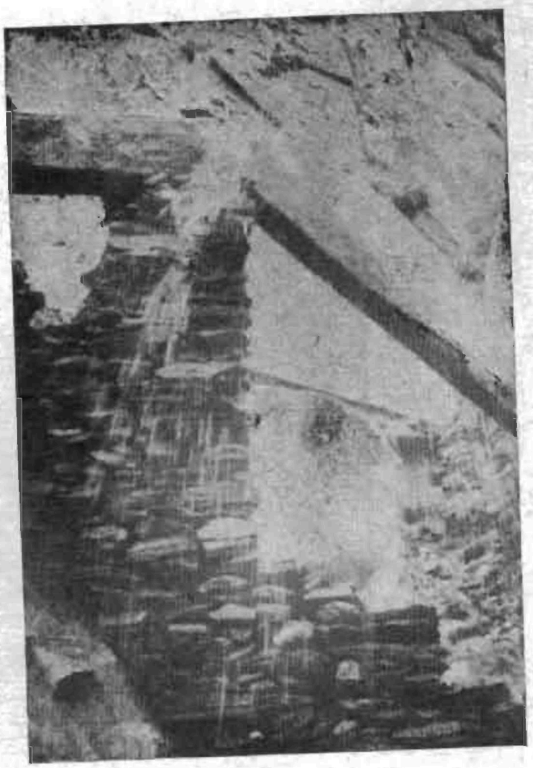
Stitching



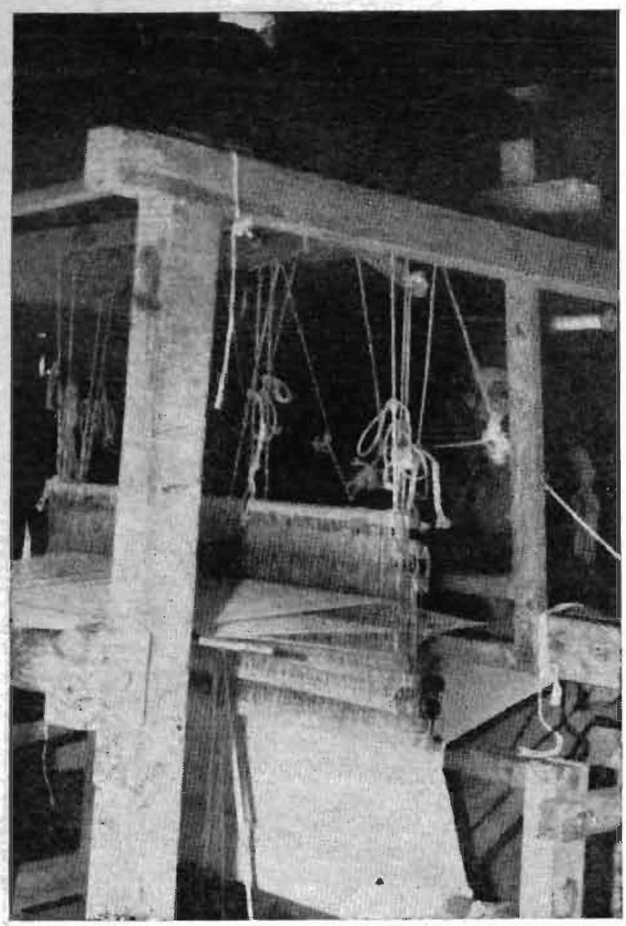
Gharat



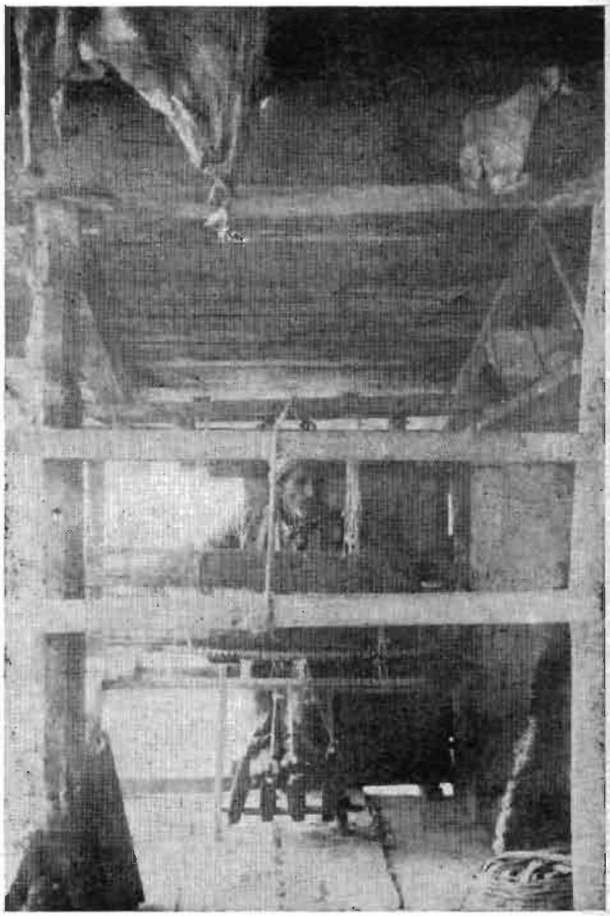
Waterfall



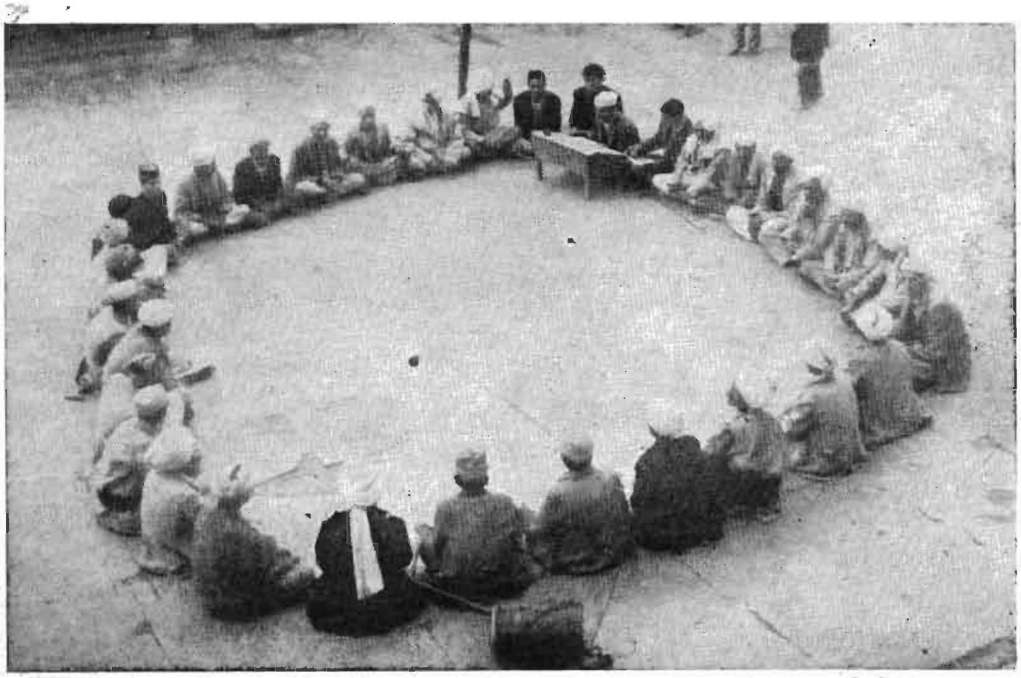
Gharat—a close-up



Loom



Weaving



Panchayat in Session



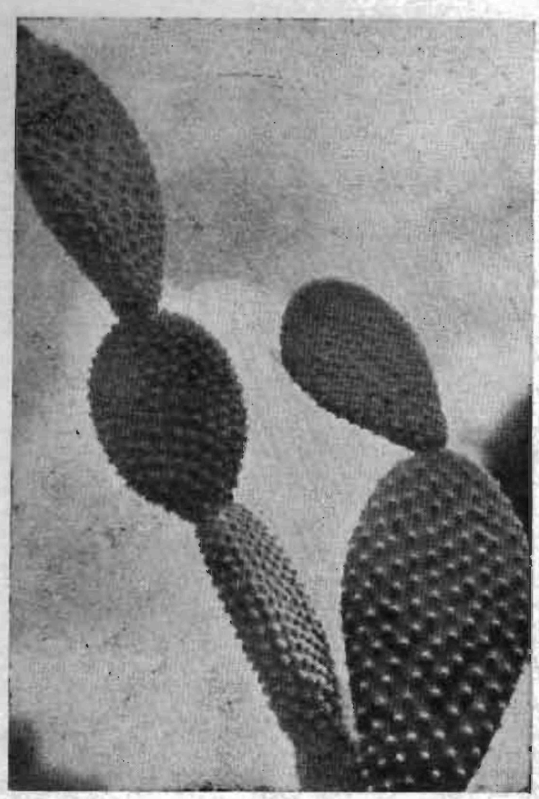
Shakti Devi



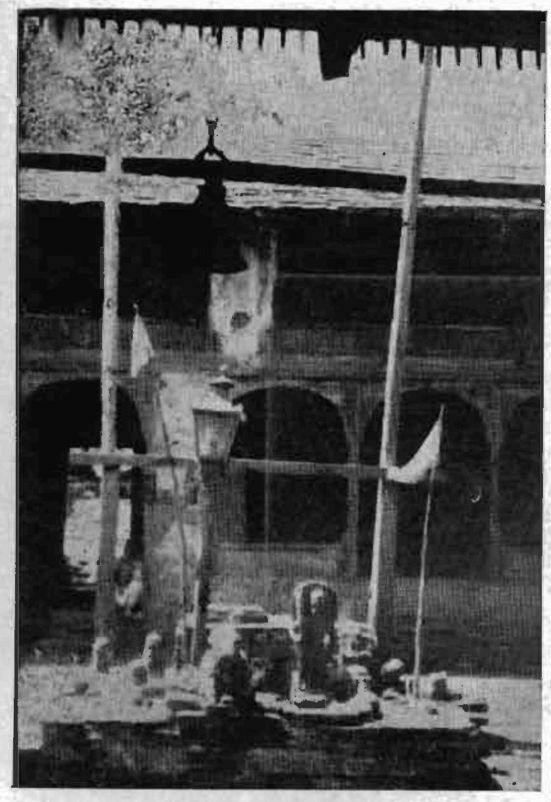
The Goddess



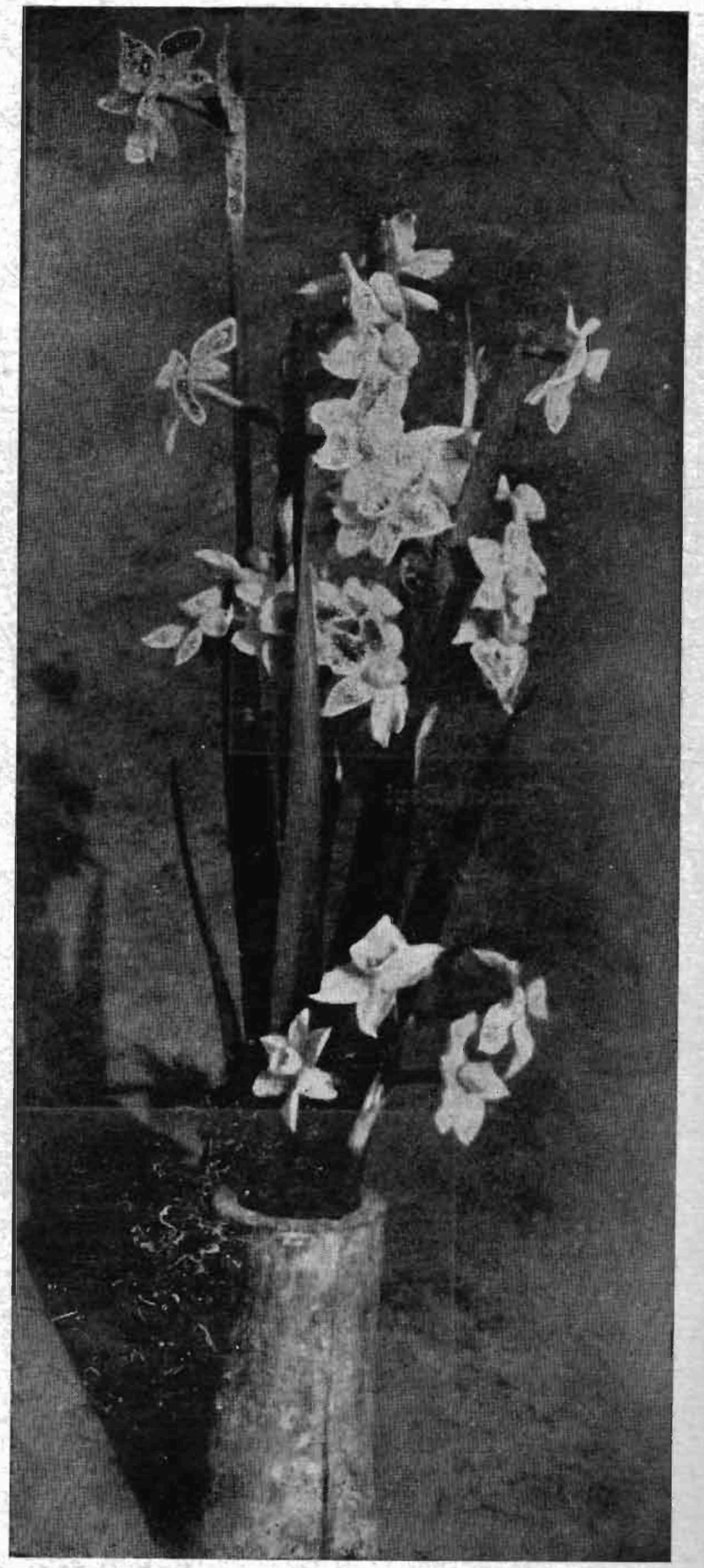
Chitrari Temple



Cactus



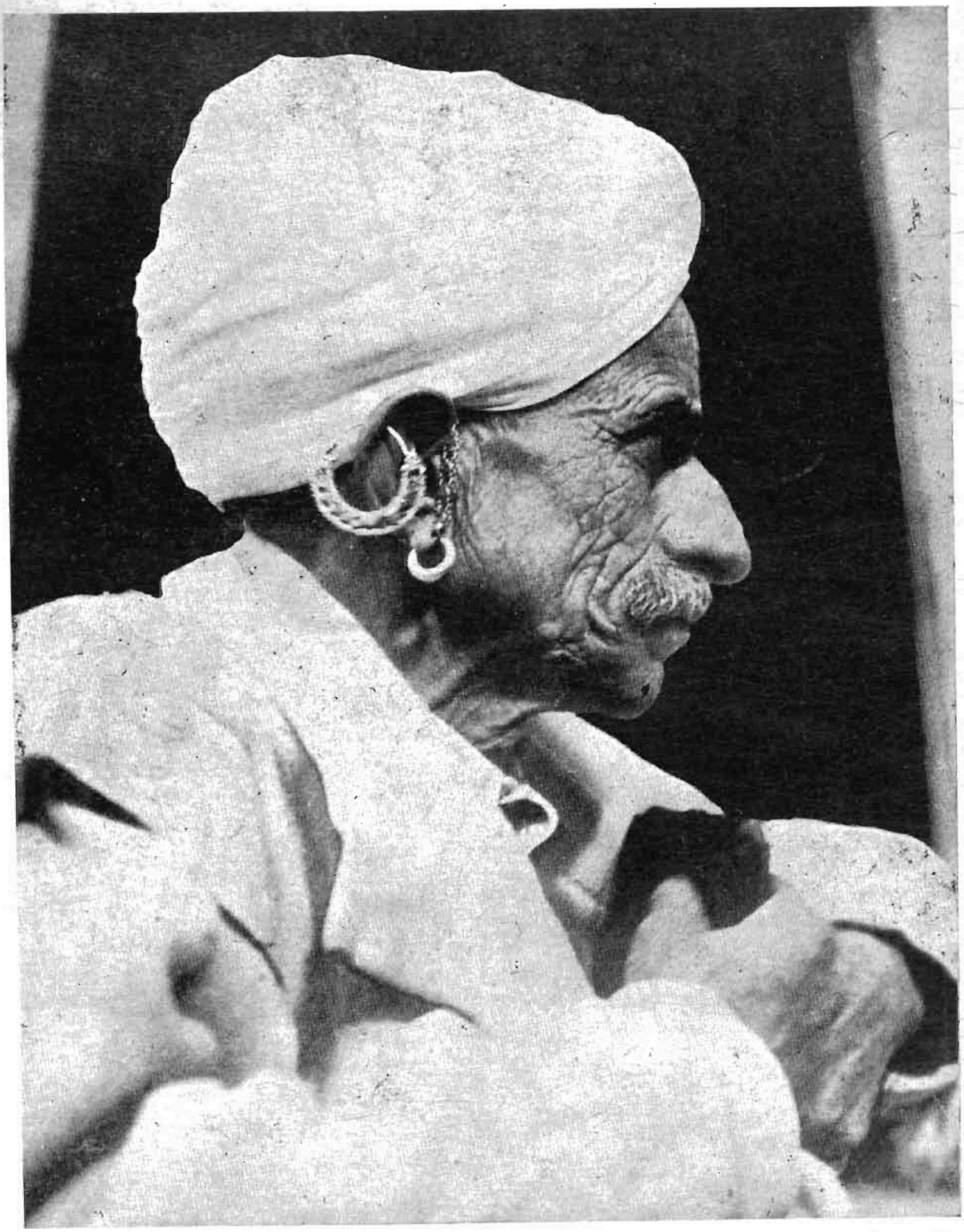
Deities



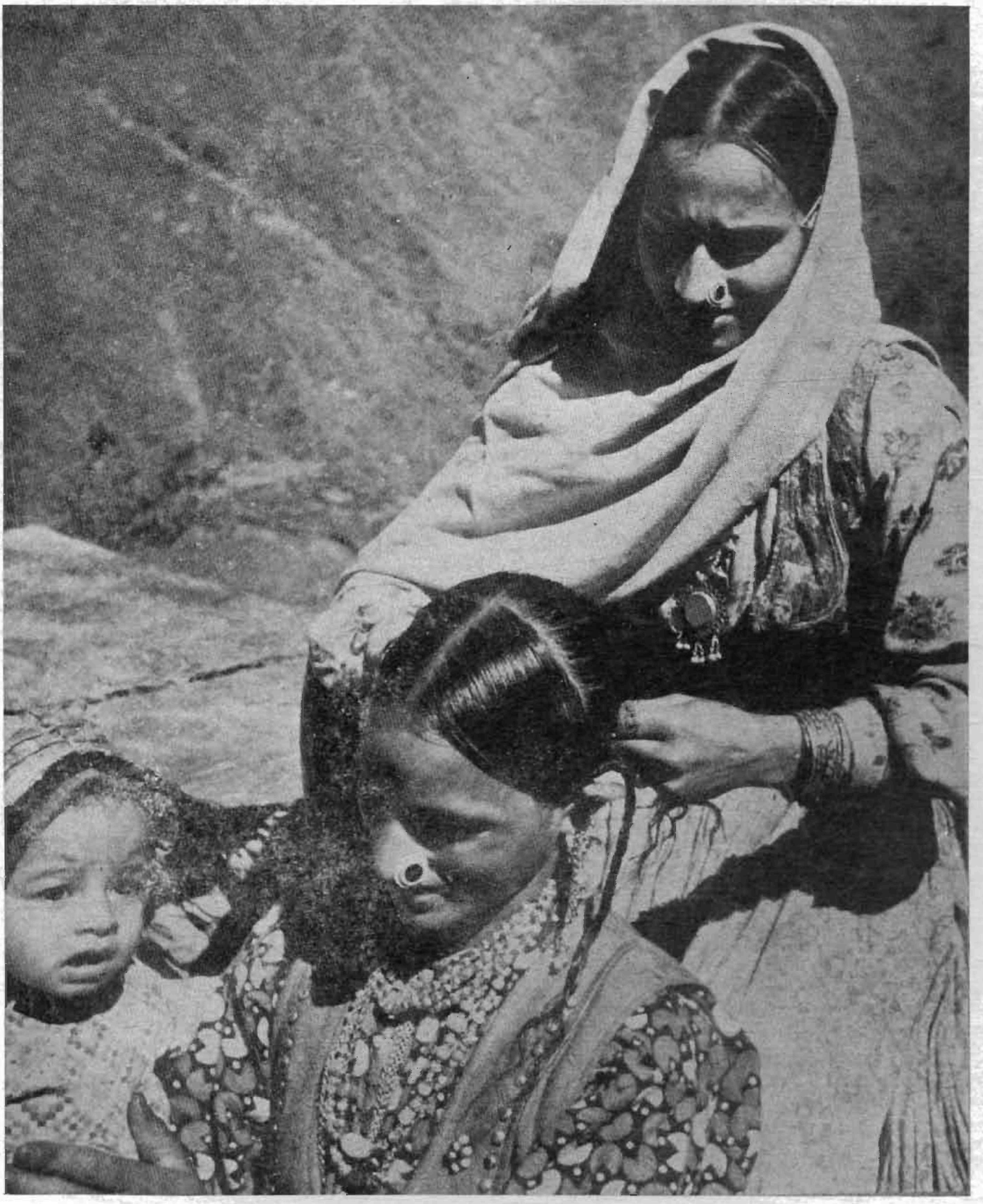
Narcissus



The deity.



An old visitor to the Fair



Dressing for the Fair



Dances



Dancing



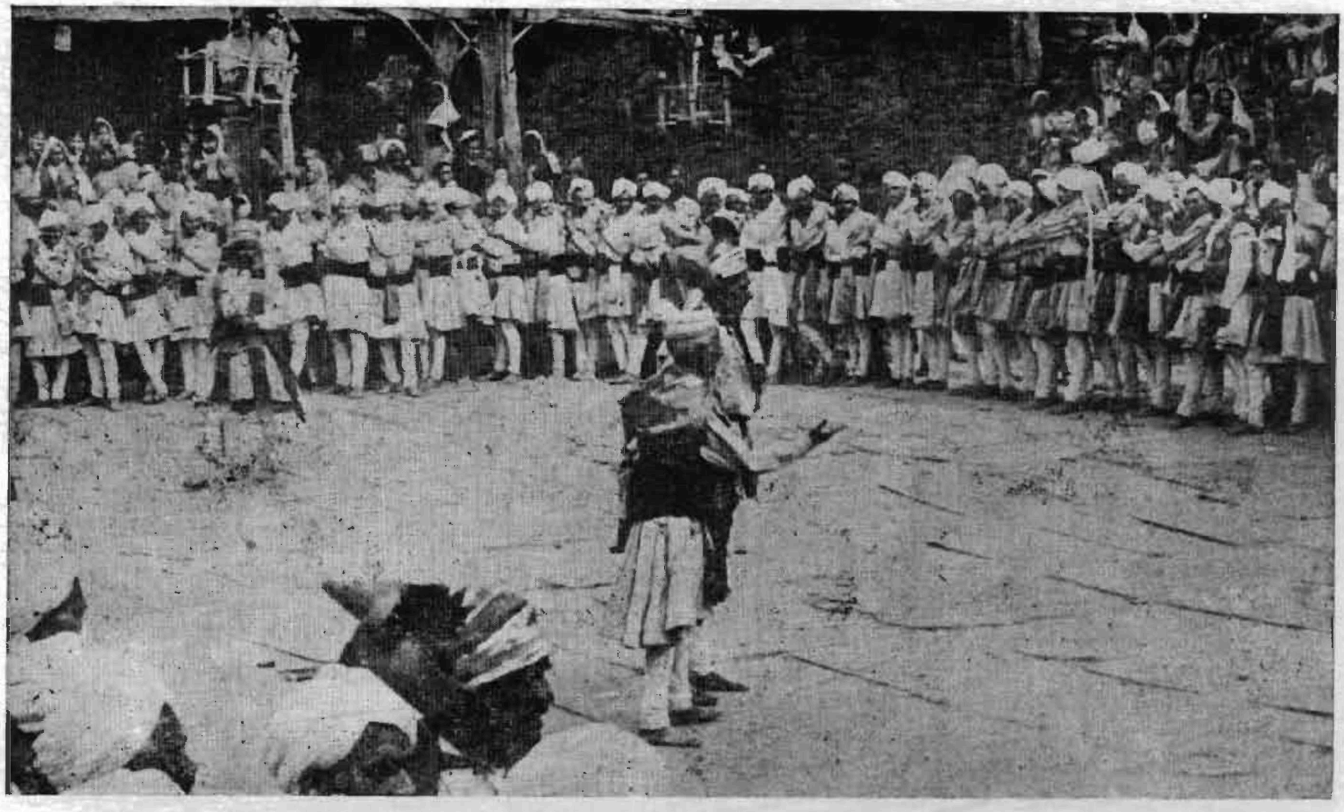
Spectators



Sati Temple



Procession in the Fair



More dances



Polygamy



Masks



Dancing in the crowd

लोकगीत नं:- २

कपड़े धोआं कन्ने रोआं कुंजुआ,
मुक्खों बोल जबानी ओ,
मेरे कुन्जुआ मुक्खों बोल जबानी ओ।

हत्थां बिच रेशमी रमाल चंचलो।
बिच्च छल्ला नशानी ओ,
मेरिये जिंदे, बिच्च छल्ला नशानी ओ।

काली अक्खियां अम्बे दियां फांडां
बिच अत्थरूं नशानी ओ,
मेरिये जिंदे, बिच्च अत्थरुं नशानी ओ।

गोरी गोरी बांए लाल चूड़ा चंचलो।
बिच गजरा नशानी ओ,
मेरिये जिंदे, बिच गजरा नशानी ओ।

अद्दी अद्दी रातीं मती औंदा कुन्जुआ,
पंज भरियां बन्दूकां ओ।
मेरे कुन्जुआ पंज भरियां बन्दूकां ओ।

अद्दी अद्दी रातीं असां औना चंचलो।
की करनां बन्दूकां ओ,
मेरिये जिंदे, की करना बन्दूकां ओ।

तूं ते चला परदेस कुंजुआ।
देईजा डुठी नशानी ओ,
मेरे कुन्जुआ देई जा डूठी नशानी हो।

डूठी दा बसोस मत करां चंचलो।
चम्बे सून्ना [illegible] ओं।
मेरिये जिंदे चम्बे [illegible] ओ।

[illegible]

देयां जिंद बी बारी ओ।
[illegible]

[illegible]

English version of Kunju songg:-

1. I weep profusely.
   while washing clothes, O Kunjua
   come and speak to me, please
   come and talk with me.
2. In your hand is a silk handkerchief, O Chanchalo,
   and my ring is on your finger,
   as a token of our undying love.
3. My lustrous black eyes. O Kunjua, often admired by you, are now filled with tears and sorrow,
   symbols of our hopeless love.
4. On your fair arms.
   the red bangles quiver,
   and among them O Chanchalo,
   is the bracelet I gave you
   in token of my adoration.
5. Do not come to me at midnight, O Kunjun
   there are five loaded rifles in my house
   itching to fire at your heart.
6. I will surely come at midnight, O Chanchalo,
   what harm can five rifles do
   to my immortal love for you?
7. You are going far away, O Kunjua.
   give me a ring as a token of your love.
8. Do not bother about such trifles, O Chanchalo,
   In Chamba there is gold in plenty
   and I will deck you with ornaments.
9. Do not leave tomorrow night, O Kunjua,
   do not leave me,
   I would sacrifice my very life
   to keep you here.
10. I must go tomorrow night, O Chanchalo,
    I must go for I have pressing work which I cannot ignore.

[illegible] नं:- ३

[illegible] लाडलीये अज हुई पराई
होरी दे लड़े [illegible] लाई [illegible] अज [illegible] पराई
पहल [illegible] बापू दी लाडली, अज हुई [illegible]।
चाचे दीये लाडलीये अज हुई पराई।
होरी दे लड़े छोड़ी लाई अज हुई पराई
पहले थी चाचू दी लाडली अज हुई पराई
[illegible] दीइये [illegible] लाडलीये अज हुई पराई
होरी दे लड़े छोड़ी लाई धीये अज हुई पराई
पहले थी [illegible] दी लाडली अज हुई [illegible]
[illegible] दी [illegible] लाडलीये अज हुई [illegible]
होरी दे लड़े छोड़ी लाई धीये अज हुई पराई
पहले थी [illegible] दी लाडलीये अज हुई [illegible]।।

This song is sung at the time of the departure of the bride. The ladies of the house sing it with a heavy heart and the scene is so poignant that every eye is moist. In this song. the poignant truth is brought forward that henceforward the bride has gone to the other house-hold and she has become parai (belonging to others). The song says that the beloved daughter of the father, beloved niece of the uncle, and the most beloved daughter of the mother has ceased to be a member of the parental house-hold and now belongs to the other household.

Courtesy—Dr. Karan Singh—"Sunlight and Shadow" Asia Publications.